

GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: **Republic of Armenia**

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report:

Deputy Minister of Education, Science, Culture and Sport of the Republic of Armenia

I. Information on the legislative, judicial, administrative and other measures taken by the state at the national level

1. Ratification of the Convention¹

Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

☒ Yes

☐ No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

☐ Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country:

☐ Close to ratification

☐ Underway

☐ Actively under preparation

- Please briefly explain the difficulties encountered in completing the ratification process and the means of overcoming them:

Describe:

➔ *the obstacles, whether legal, institutional, political or practical*

➔ *the means of overcoming them and the extent to which UNESCO can assist in completing the process*

☐ No, not considering ratification in the near future. Please explain why:

¹ http://portal.unesco.org/en/ev.php-URL_ID=12949&URL_DO=DO_TOPIC&URL_SECTION=201.html

2. Ratification of the Protocol² instituting a Conciliation and Good Offices Commission to be responsible for seeking the settlement of any disputes which may arise between States Parties to the Convention against Discrimination in Education

Has your country ratified the Protocol?

☒ Yes

☐ No, please briefly explain the difficulties encountered:

3. Legal framework governing the protection of rights guaranteed in the Convention and the Recommendation in the national legal system

In case your country is a State Party to the Convention:

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law following its ratification?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- If not, has it been incorporated into the national Constitution or domestic law so as to be directly applicable?

☐ Yes ☐ No

This seeks information on whether the provisions of the Convention are guaranteed in a domestic legal instrument. The report should list the main legal texts (Constitution, legislative text or other provisions) adopted to guarantee the right to education for all and to promote equal educational opportunities. References, dates and aims could be provided.

- Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked before and given effect to by courts, tribunals and administrative authorities?

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, please illustrate on the basis of available case law and jurisprudence. Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the rights guaranteed by the Convention and the scope of such competence.

In case your country is not a State Party to the Convention:

- Have legislative measures been taken pursuant to the Recommendation?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, the report could list the main texts adopted to guarantee the right to education for all and to promote equal educational opportunities. References, dates and aims could be provided.

- Please explain briefly the extent to which public policies and programmes correspond to the general provisions of the Recommendation.

Information supplied could demonstrate how such policies and programmes comply with commitments of the right to education under the Recommendation.

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation

1. Non-discrimination and equal opportunities in education in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-discrimination and equal opportunities in education. This part relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality of educational opportunity.

*This corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to “**ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all**” by 2030. It therefore covers all the SDG4 targets, but also specifically SDG target 4.5.³*

- 1.1 Please indicate measures adopted by your government to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation (please tick all that apply)⁴ (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- ☒ Constitutional laws and/or legislation prohibit discrimination in education
- ☒ Regulations prohibit discrimination in education
- ☒ Policies and programmes aim to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education
- ☒ Access to justice in case of violations of the right to non-discrimination in education

☐ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum

☐ Other:

³ Which calls on states to “eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

⁴ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

Please provide a brief description of the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts including measures on:

- ➔ *Non-discrimination in the admission of pupils to educational institutions*
- ➔ *Non-differential treatment, including of foreign nationals resident in your country*

The Republic of Armenia acceded, on 5 September 1993, to the UNESCO Convention against Discrimination in Education adopted on 14 December 1960.

Since its independence the Republic of Armenia have been adopted laws (as well as other legal acts) targeted at ensuring equal access to education and excluding discrimination in education, regardless of cultural, economic, political and other conditions, as well as at assisting in ensuring equal opportunities for education.

In particular:

The first Constitution of the Republic of Armenia was adopted on 5 July 1995, in which fundamental rights and freedoms of persons and citizens are enshrined. For the purpose of implementing in recent years comprehensive reforms, amendments to the Constitution of the Republic of Armenia were adopted on 6 December 2015. The following provision on discrimination is enshrined in Article 29: "Discrimination based on sex, race, skin colour, ethnic or social origin, genetic features, language, religion, world view, political or other views, affiliation to a national minority, property status, birth, disability, age, or personal or social circumstances shall be prohibited." The right to education is enshrined in Article 38: "Everyone shall have the right to education. The programmes of compulsory education and the duration thereof shall be prescribed by law. Secondary education in state education institutions shall be free of charge. Everyone shall, in the cases and in the manner prescribed by law, have the right to free of charge education on a competitive basis in state higher and other vocational education institutions. Higher education institutions shall, to the extent prescribed by law, have the right to self-governance, including academic freedom and freedom of research".

The Law of the Republic of Armenia (H.N.-0772-1-HO-52) "On language" was adopted on 17 April 1993, which prescribes the main provisions of the language policy of the Republic of Armenia, regulates the state of language, language relations of the bodies of state power and public administration, enterprises, institutions and organisations.

The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-297) "On education" was adopted on 14 April 1999, which, based on the constitutional provisions, to a certain extent, guides the development of the education system. This Law stipulates state guarantees for the right to education, pursuant to which: "The Republic of Armenia shall ensure the right to education, regardless of the nationality, race, gender, language, belief, political or other views, social origin, property status or other circumstances." The legal equality of women and men has also been provided for in this Law.

Following implementation of the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On education", a number of legal acts regulating separate fields of education have been adopted as well. In particular:

For the purpose of implementing the state policy in the field of general education, ensuring the quality of and access to education, as well as improving the legislative framework of education, the Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-233-N) "On state inspectorate of education" was adopted on 15 November 2005, and the Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-160-N) "On general education" was adopted on 10 July 2009.

The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-200-N) "On making supplements and amendments to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On general education'" was adopted on 1 December 2014, which provides for a transition from the system of general education to universal inclusive education. The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-20-N) "On making amendments and supplements to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On education'" was also adopted on 8 April 2015, which prescribes the compulsory condition for a free of charge twelve-year (including vocational education) education. The Law shall enter into force from 1 January 2017.

The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-164-N) "On primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education" was adopted on 8 July 2005.

The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-62-N) "On higher and post-graduate professional education" was adopted on 14 December 2004.

For the purpose of improving the legal framework for supplementary and continuing education, the Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-83-N) "On making supplements and amendments to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On education'" was adopted on 21 June 2014, which served as a basis for the approval of the Procedure for organising and implementing supplementary education programmes, prescribed by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1062-N of 10 September 2015, as well as the Procedure for evaluating and recognising the results of non-formal and informal instruction, prescribed by point 2 of the same Decision.

The principles of the state policy of the Republic of Armenia at different levels of education, the legal and organisational, financial and economic grounds, the legal relations of natural and legal persons participating in the education process, the grounds for the right to education at different levels of education enshrined in the Constitution of the Republic of Armenia, etc., are regulated by the above-mentioned laws.

The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-57-N) "On ensuring equal rights and equal opportunities for women and men" was also adopted on 20 May 2013.

Following adoption of the mentioned laws, a number of legal acts have also been approved, supporting correct implementation of the laws.

1.2 Please indicate actions taken by your government to guarantee equal access to all levels and types of education in your country (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- ☒ Constitutional laws and/or legislation guarantee equal access to education
- ☒ Regulations ensure equal access to all levels and types of education
- ☒ Policies and programmes ensure equal access to all levels and types of education

☐ Other:

- Please indicate the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts and provide a brief description of the measures taken:

This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b⁵

Education in the Republic of Armenia is provided in accordance with the requirements of the Law of the Republic of Armenia “On language”: “The official language of the Republic of Armenia is Armenian which shall serve all spheres of life of the Republic. The language of teaching and upbringing in education and learning systems within the territory of the Republic of Armenia is literary Armenian. In the communities of national minorities of the Republic of Armenia general education instruction and upbringing may be organised in their native language in accordance with the state programme as well as with state support, by compulsory instruction of Armenian”.

Admission of a learner to a school of general education is carried out pursuant to Procedure for admission to, transfer from and removal of a learner from the institution of general education approved by Order of the Minister of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia No 1640-N of 24 November 2010.

General education is provided starting from the age of six which may be attained by the end of the given calendar year. Admission of learners to an institution of general education is carried out on the basis of the application of the parent of a school-age child or the legal representative thereof or the contract concluded between the institution and the parent. The parent shall be responsible — as prescribed by law — for failure to ensure the right of the child to general education (or failure to enrol in school) before attaining the age of 16.

At the 3rd level of general education – high school –students may pursue further studies only upon availability of the basic school graduation certificate.

The admission to school of children of a citizen belonging to a national minority is carried out through instructing the child in his or her national (native) language or at school (classroom) providing a course in that language and in case of absence thereof the choice of the language of instruction is made by the parents of the children (learners).

The choice of the language of instruction for children of foreign citizens, persons not having Armenian citizenship, those with dual citizenship, as well as where one of the parents is a citizen of the Republic of Armenia and the other is a foreigner is made by the parents of these children (their legal representative).

Admission to state and accredited non-state institutions of handicraft and secondary vocational education shall be carried out according to the admission procedure approved by the Order of the Minister of Education and Science for the given academic year.

For the purpose of sparking interest in secondary vocational education and increasing the enrolment of learners at this level, since 2011-2012 academic year admission has been carried out without admission examinations, except for professions pertaining to the fields of art, healthcare and sports. In this case, the competition-based admission (including primary vocational (handicraft)) is carried out on the basis of arithmetic mean of the grades in the graduation document and the total sum of the grades in the subjects considered to be competitive.

Admission to a higher professional education institution is carried out pursuant to Procedure for admission to state and non-state higher education institutions (according to Bachelor's degree education programme) approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 597-N of 26 April 2012.

Admission to higher professional education institutions of the Republic of Armenia is also

carried out on a competitive basis, based on admission examinations.

Pursuant to the above-mentioned procedure, winners of International Olympiads in different subjects of general education instructed at a secondary school, medalists of World and European championships for different sports — having indicated the relevant professions in the admission application — are admitted to higher a education institution without admission examinations with the use of reserve seats allocated by the Government of the Republic of Armenia.

Persons with secondary, primary vocational or secondary vocational education may be admitted to higher education institutions without age limit.

Pursuant to the procedure, citizens of the Republic of Armenia with dual citizenship and foreigners may be admitted to higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia on general grounds or according to the procedure for admission of foreigners to education institutions.

Admission to Master's degree and doctoral studies is carried out respectively in accordance with Procedure for admission to and instruction in Master's degree programme in higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia approved by Order of the Minister of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia No 1193-N of 6 December 2007 and Procedure for admission to and instruction within doctoral studies, as well as for registration for post-doctoral studies and external research approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 238-N of 25 February 2016.

Thus, the process of admission of learners at different levels of education is regulated by legal acts approved for that purpose and discrimination is excluded.

As regards the rights and obligations of the learners of different levels and other participants in the educational process, they are regulated by Laws of the Republic of Armenia "On general education", "On primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education" and "On higher and postgraduate professional education", as well as by the statutes of educational institutions. Thus, the noted legal acts regulate the relations established between the participants in the educational process, as well as non-discriminatory attitude.

- 1.3 Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

☒ Providing financial incentives and fellowships

☒ Providing positive or affirmative action measures

☒ Ensuring inclusion in mainstream schools for all learners

☒ Training teachers on inclusive education

☒ Providing auxiliary assistance

☒ Adapting education infrastructure

☒ Adapting curricula and methods

☒ Providing language classes to newcomers (e.g. refugees)

☒ Eliminating administrative barriers to education⁶

⁶ Administrative barriers to education include, amongst others, lack of identity papers or birth certificates required to enrol.

☐ Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) and technical and vocational training (TVET)

☐ Providing re-entry programmes for young mothers

☐ Eliminating all barriers for pregnant girls or young mothers in education

☐ Other:

☐ Providing flexible learning pathways

☒ Valuing diversity in schools

☒ Combatting stereotyping and stigmatisation

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken, including those to ensure *gender equality and the empowerment of girls and women in and through education*:

According to data of the Statistical Committee of the Republic of Armenia, almost entire population of Armenia is literate. According to the results of Census 2011, only 0.3% of the population is illiterate. The rate of literacy of people aged 15-24 comprises approximately 100%, and the ratio of the number of literate women to men aged 15-24 comprises 1. Thus, the literacy rate of adults and young people comprises approximately 99%, and there is no significant gender inequality in this regard.

Concurrently, in 2018 the enrolment picture at different levels of education is as follows: gross enrolment ratio at school of general education comprised 83.0%; moreover at elementary school it comprised 91.1%, at basic school — 89.4%, at high school — 59.9%. The enrolment ratio of learners in the field of primary vocational (handicraft) education comprised 6.7% and in the field of secondary vocational education — 11.7%. Gross enrolment ratio of learners in the field of higher professional education comprised 38.3%. Gross enrolment ratio in the first level degree of higher professional education comprised 52.2%, whereas in the second level degree — 14.1%. Overall, in 2018 the enrollment in the vocational education system made 54.6% among the population subject to education.

Conditioned by the requirements for successfully carrying out reforms in the field of education, "Prospective Development Strategic Programme of the Republic of Armenia for 2014-2025" approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 442-N of 27 March 2014 envisaged consistent increase in state expenditures for education both in rated value and against the GDP ensuring the target of 3.7% against GDP by 2025. Nonetheless, the economic recession, decrease in GDP and narrowing of the scope of budget resources limited the possibilities for maintaining the expenditures in the envisaged amounts.

The majority of state allocations targeted at the field of education — over 76.6%, was directed towards the financing of the field of general education in 2018 and 18.0% — towards the financing of professional education programmes.

According to Prospective Development Strategic Programme of the Republic of Armenia for 2014-2025: "The field of education in Armenia is highlighted as one of the preconditions for sustainable progress of the country, reproduction and development of human capital, therefore, the development of this field is deemed to be one of the priorities for development of the country.

Increasing education quality and effectiveness at all levels of the education system,

bringing them in line with international standards, ensuring affordable/accessible education for all the strata of the population are priority objectives."

For the purpose of ensuring equally accessible quality education and increasing the effectiveness of the field of education, reforms at all levels of education are being implemented in the country. Separate strategies and concepts also support those reforms. Moreover, all the processes implemented in the field of education are targeted at exercise of the right to education — equally for both women and men, without any discrimination — enshrined in the Constitution of the Republic of Armenia.

General education is a priority in the sector of education as a basis for preparing children for independent life and further professional education. A range of initiatives have been implemented in the field of general education, in particular:

- a new mechanism for financing schools is applied (financing is carried out according to the number of pupils of the school);

- 12-year education system has been introduced, the process of publishing new textbooks and fully providing the learners with textbooks has been implemented. Textbook circulation system — ongoing mechanism for publishing textbooks — has been applied, which has led to reduction of expenses for obtaining textbooks, while the pupils of a more vulnerable group are provided with textbooks free of charge. Free of charge textbooks are also provided to pupils of 1st-4th years at the expense of state funds;

- courses ensuring comprehensive development of a person and applied qualities acquired by means of education have been introduced. For the purpose of developing robotics in schools of general education, robotics groups have been established in general education institutions of the Republic. As of January 2020, 575 engineering laboratories operate on the territory of Armenia. Around 15000 students get free engineering education. At Armath Engineering Laboratories kids aged 10-18 are introduced to science, technology, engineering, and math education through interactive after-school classes, exciting competitions, innovative camps and more;

- the subjects "Information Technologies", "Basics of Telecommunication" and "Microelectronics" were introduced in high schools. Introduction of the subject "National Songs and Dances" was a new step, which envisages preserving and passing on national values to generations, establishing a value system, instilling patriotism, preserving Armenian mindset. Introduction of the subject "Chess" was unprecedented, which sparked interest among the international educational community;

- unified examination system for school graduation and admission to higher education institutions has been applied, as a result of which the process of transition of learners from school to higher education institutions has been facilitated;

- a network of high schools, operating separately and comprising 99 schools has been applied. High school (10th-12th years) is the main level ensuring pre-vocational education which greatly affects correct professional orientation and further learning success of learners. High schools have been provided with the required school property, computer devices, laboratories for physics, chemistry, biology, modern libraries equipped with literature;

- the application of modern information and communication technologies, as a new

means for teaching and learning, has been expanded. Therefore, Internet access and equipment with computer devices in schools have been improved. "Armenian educational portal" (www.armedu.am, <https://heravar.armedu.am/>) has been developed, the content has been replenished and updated, on-line educational events have been organised (contests, Olympiads, conferences, discussions, surveys, photography and other creative competitions etc.); the system "Distance learning" has been applied (<http://learning.armedu.am>), by which distance courses of eight school subjects of the advanced stream of the 10th year (Armenian language, Russian language, Foreign language (English), Algebra, Physics, Chemistry, Biology, Armenian History) were organised for pupils of high school; the website "Database for Digital Resources" (<http://lib.armedu.am>) has been operated, where textbooks and training manuals, educational and methodical materials, subject related criteria and programmes have been posted; each year Republican Olympiads of 16 subjects of general education have been organised for schoolchildren, while Armenia has had team participation in International Olympiads of the subjects "Mathematics", "Physics", "Chemistry", "Information Science", "Astronomy" and "Biology";

In the system of primary and secondary vocational education:

Procedure for granting student allowance and state stipend in state education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, implementing primary vocational (handicraft) and/or secondary vocational education programmes, was approved by Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No1330-N of 28 November 2013. In order to increase the involvement of learners also at this level of education, since 2011-2012 academic year, admission has been carried out without admission examinations, except for professions pertaining to the fields of art, healthcare and sports;

steps have been taken to ensure involvement of children — in need of special conditions for education — of vulnerable groups in the system of primary and secondary vocational education, facility conditions of some institutions have been adapted for persons with disabilities. Increased funding for financing the provision of education for children in need of special conditions for education and state non-commercial organisations of the Republic of Armenia implementing primary vocational (handicraft) education has been established and introduced according to point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 884-N of 15 July 2010.

In the system of higher and postgraduate professional education:

Procedure for granting student allowance and state stipend in higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, which was approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1183-N of 27 July 2006, has been implemented since 2006. Competitive education and the idea of student rotation according to academic performance play an essential role within the general context of the mentioned reforms. Pursuant to the requirements of the mentioned Procedure, the state shall continue to refund the tuition fees of socially disadvantaged students in the amount of 50-100%;

the expansion of joint programmes implemented by higher education institutions through contracts signed between higher education institutions, based on common educational standards, is underway. With the support of the EU, student exchange and joint education programmes, as well as review of education

programmes according to educational outcomes are being carried out at higher education institutions;

Procedure for distance learning of professions of higher and post-graduate professional education has been introduced since 2010, which will enable to make the application of e-environment, innovative technologies in the fields of education and science more systematic and ensure additional educational opportunities for citizens;

Pursuant to the Procedure for granting student allowance and state stipend in higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, the State has implemented refund of tuition fees for socially disadvantaged students in the amount of 50-100 %. In 2015, the procedure for reviewing the mechanisms aimed at refund of tuition fees for students of socially vulnerable groups was implemented, the circle of socially disadvantaged students was expanded — including also first year students.

Tumo Center for Creative Technologies is run in Armenia which was founded in Armenia and then became a brand for export. Currently 3 such centers function in Armenia and two more are planned to be launched in 2020. With Tumo Armenia became a country of innovative laboratory of ideas which has already started exporting it to the countries such as France, Lebanon, Artsakh and Germany, and to Albania in new future. Students of 12-28 age group attend the centers in Armenia for 14 various educational programs including graphic design, programming and robotics. The programs are available equally for boys and girls.

On 20 May 2013, the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On ensuring equal rights and equal opportunities for women and men" (HO-57-N) was adopted, which prescribes the guarantees for ensuring equal rights and equal opportunities of women and men in political, social, economic, cultural, as well as other fields of public life, and regulates the relations arising with regard thereto. The purpose of this Law is to ensure equality of women and men in all fields of public life - including the sectors of education and culture, legal protection of women and men against possible discrimination, support for formation of civil society, and the establishment of democratic relations in the society.

In order to promote legal equality between women and men and prevent discrimination, public administration bodies of the Republic of Armenia, along with several international organisations, such as OSCE Yerevan Office (until 2017), UN Population Fund, etc., implement various programmes, which assist the authorities and the civil society in improving the legislation. At the same time, works are being implemented with the media to improve the coverage of existing problems and to break the stereotypes. Data on the involvement of both men and women at different levels of education are presented in the following subpoints.

The admission of foreign nationals (including representatives of the Armenian Diaspora) to vocational education institutions of the Republic of Armenia is regulated by international treaties of the Republic of Armenia on co-operation in the sectors of education and science concluded between the Republic of Armenia and other states, as well as in accordance with the Procedure for admission of foreign nationals, as well as members of families of diplomats working in the diplomatic service bodies of the Republic of Armenia, operating in a foreign state, to higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 700-N of 28 April 2011, the Procedure for admission to

primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1295-N of 25 August 2011.

The purpose of the existence of separate procedures for admission is to:

- make education at educational institutions of the Republic of Armenia accessible for foreign nationals;

- contribute to upbringing with the spirit of respect towards nations and mutual understanding, help spark interest among the youth in Armenian cultural heritage and contribute to the development of Armenian studies.

Foreign nationals having received secondary education in the Republic of Armenia and residing in Armenia (including refugees, asylum seeker, etc.) may also be admitted to primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational, higher education and research institutions on a general basis. The examination questions are translated during entrance examinations for those lacking knowledge of the Armenian language. In the rest of the cases, all the prescribed conditions of the competition apply to them equally, and in case of earning high points — they have the right to benefit from free of charge (stipend) seats.

Applicants having preferred to be admitted through the procedure for admission for foreign nationals may be admitted to the fee paid education system (first year) of primary vocational (handicraft), secondary vocational and higher education institutions, where they are fluent in the Armenian language and have minimum knowledge of the examination subjects. Foreign applicants having been admitted to state higher professional education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, with no knowledge of the Armenian language, are admitted to the preparatory faculty (departments) of higher education institutions for a one-year period, where they learn Armenian and study admission examination subjects.

According to the mentioned procedure, foreigners of Armenian origin or representatives of Armenian Diaspora may be allocated with 70 free of charge (stipend) seats where they have applied for the professions of Armenian studies, Pedagogy and Art.

Foreign citizens are provided with dormitories, if they wish.

Since 2012, tuition fees of Syrian-Armenian students have been fully or partially — 70-75 % — refunded at the expense of resources of the Government of the Republic of Armenia, The Armenian General Benevolent Union and the Calouste Gulbenkian Foundation.

Steps have been taken to introduce the universal inclusive education system, in particular:

On 1 December 2014, the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On making amendments to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On general education'" (HO-200-N) was adopted, which provides that the universal inclusive education system shall be introduced in the Republic of Armenia until 1 August 2025. For the purpose of ensuring implementation of the Law, "Action plan and the timetable of the universal inclusive education system introduction activities" have been approved by point 1 of Protocol Decision No 6-12 of the Government of the Republic of Armenia of 18 February 2016. According to the Action Plan and the Timetable, a number of special institutions of general education of the Republic will be reorganised into pedagogical and psychological support centres. As a result of implementation of the system, children in need of special conditions for education will receive a pedagogical and psychological support service at 3 levels: in the school of general education, in the territorial and republican pedagogical and

psychological support centres. A new form of funding will be introduced in schools of general education and a vacancy for a teaching assistant will be made available. The introduction of the system will be carried out step by step, starting from regions and gradually covering the whole territory of the Republic. The process started in 2016. The universal inclusive education system has been introduced in 7 regions of RA. The US Agency for International Development, the Office of the United Nations Children's Fund in Armenia, "World Vision Armenia" International Development and Charitable Organisation, "Bridge of Hope" NGO assist in the implementation of the Programme. The newly-established system will allow to organise the education and upbringing of children in need of special conditions for education without separating children from their families, ensuring their comprehensive social development and enrolling them in an institution of general education. Through the policy pursued in the field, it is envisaged to promote the opportunities of receiving quality education for children in need of special conditions for education by introducing an inclusive education system in all schools of general education. As a result of the transition to a universal inclusive education system, the number of special schools is decreasing year by year. Currently, there are 10 special schools in Armenia, instead of the previous 23.

The "Sun" talking computer programme functions in special school No 14 for visually impaired children in Yerevan; the school is equipped with over 6 textbooks printed in Braille, as well as 2000 workbooks.

A special class for sign language instruction is organised at Yerevan Special Educational Complex for Children with Hearing Impairments, which is the only institution in the Republic to organise education for deaf children. The Bilingual Method is applied at the school; teaching is carried out by two methods: sign language and mother tongue.

Pursuant to point 105 of the Procedure for admission to state and non-state higher education institutions (according to the educational programme for the Bachelor's degree) approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 597-N of 26 April 2012, citizens disabled while performing their duties during compulsory military service, in case of successfully passing the examinations, shall be admitted on an out-of-competition basis, at the expense of the funds of the State Budget of the Republic of Armenia.

Besides, pursuant to point 106 of the mentioned Procedure, persons of the first or second groups of disability and children with disabilities under the age of 18 who have scored enough points to get admitted under the fee paid system, shall be admitted to free of charge system at the expense of the funds of the State Budget of the Republic of Armenia.

The mentioned procedures are of a continuous nature, and in order to receive funding, a higher education institution must submit an application to the Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sport of the Republic of Armenia.

Furthermore, measures are being implemented to adapt the buildings of educational institutions to the needs of persons with disabilities. The 5th and 9th blocks of the National Polytechnic University of Armenia have been adapted to the needs of persons with disabilities. A programme converting the existing literature into audio books was installed in one of the computers in the reading hall of the Armenian State Pedagogical University after Kh. Abovyan for visually challenged visitors. The lecture halls on the first floors of the blocks of Yerevan Brusov State University of Languages and Social Sciences, of the Armenian State Institute of Physical Culture and Sport are adapted to

the needs of persons with movement disorders, therefore classes for students with movement disorders are conducted on the first floor. Since 2014, "Unison" NGO has been implementing a programme aimed at introducing an inclusivity policy in higher education institutions. The inclusivity standards of higher education institutions are developed. All the stakeholders, including the representatives of higher education institutions have been involved in the process of policy development.

Besides, the buildings of educational institutions, namely kindergartens, schools of general education and colleges have been adapted to the needs of persons with disabilities (construction of wheelchair ramps, renovation of sanitary facilities, installation of platform lifts) at the expense of the funds allocated from the 2017-2019 State Budget.

The School Meals Programme has been introduced, and relevant funds have been allocated from the State Budget of the Republic of Armenia for implementation of the Programme since 2014. Meanwhile, the School Meals Programme under the United Nations World Food (UN WFP) Programme is still underway. The Government of the Republic of Armenia has undertaken the commitment of ensuring the continuity of the School Meals Programme, and to this end, the strategy and the implementation plan of the Sustainable School Meals Programme was approved by point 1 of Protocol Decision No 52-37 of the sitting of the Government of the Republic of Armenia of 27 December 2012. And in 2014-2019, the Sustainable School Meals Programme was introduced in 6 regions of the Republic. Within the framework of the Programme, children in primary classes of state schools of general education as well as children enrolled in pre-school preparation groups (pre-school education institutions) in the mentioned 6 marzes receive free of charge meals. In other regions, school meals are provided by the UN WFP. The Programme is aimed at increasing the enrolment in primary classes, as well as fostering healthy lifestyle among learners. It is envisaged to gradually increase the number of marzes included in the Programme, thus increasing the number of children receiving school meals.

- Please indicate whether your country has adopted and reviewed legislation related to the minimum age for marriage so that it conforms to international standards (18 years):

Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.

☒ Yes ☐ No

Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions:

The minimum age of marriage for women and men was set at eighteen by the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On making amendments to the Family Code of the Republic of Armenia" (HO-26) of 20 May 2013.

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education in the context of SDG 4

2.1 Pre-primary education

Pre-primary education is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of early childhood care and education (ECCE) over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation⁷. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”.

- Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available in your country?

☐ Pre-primary education is compulsory: Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:

☐ Pre-primary education is free of charge for all: Please provide the duration:

- Please list the laws and policies that ensure the availability of pre-primary education for all and provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government in the realization of access to pre-primary education. Brief quantitative information could be added.

Pre-school education is regulated by the Constitution, the laws on Education, General Education, Local Administration, Child Rights, State Non-Profit Organisations, by Labour and Family Codes, by the Republic of Armenia international agreements, other laws and legal acts.

In Armenia preschool education is not mandatory. The preschool age is 0-6-year-old. Preschool Institutions (PSI) are administered by communities. Not all the communities have operating PSIs, therefore child access level to pre-school is low. In particular, according to the data for 2018, child access to PSIs (within 0-5 age population) was 32.6% out of which 38.0% in urban and 22.6% in rural settlements. Gross participation of 3-5-year-old children in preschool in 2018 was 58.4% (56.5% boys and 60.5% girls)

With the aim to support the sector and ensure accessibility of preschool educational services, resources are allocated for piloting cost-effective models. With the financial support of World Bank, a new credit program titled Education Improvement is being implemented which supports continuous efforts towards establishing cost-effective pre-school service microprojects to raise the level of children’s readiness for school and to ensure equal starting opportunities in education. Within this project in 2016-2019 82 institutions implementing pre-school programs were sponsored with the result of 2030 more children being engaged in preschool education. It’s planned to establish 20 more preschool institutions in 2020.

To ensure sustainability of preschool programs that function as a part of secondary primary school, allocations are made from the RA state budget due to estimations

⁷ Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”.

calculated by formula for an annual spending per child in primary level. In 2019 the budget allocations mentioned above were directed for organising preschool education of 7000 children. In Yerevan the community-based kindergartens are free of charge due to the community budget allocations. Kindergartens in regions may have charges depends on the decision of community governing bodies

Following the requirements of Education 2030: Incheon Declaration and Framework for Action Towards inclusive and equitable quality education and lifelong learning for all and Education for All Declaration, on May 6, 2020, the National Assembly of Armenia has adopted the RA Law on Amendments to the Law on Preschool Education which includes the following activity framework:

- Diversify the types of organising preschool education
- Expansion of preschool services with special attention to rural and bordering settlements,
- Establish alternative cost effective models
- Set conditions for inclusion of children in need of special educational conditions.

In particular, the first part of Article 4 of the Law states that the Republic of Armenia declares and ensures inclusivity, accessibility and quality of preschool education as an important guarantee for securing each child's right to education, development and upbringing, secure environment, maintaining and strengthening life and health.

The law also guarantees accessibility and availability of pre-school education for all children from urban and rural areas through universally inclusive education, including children with disabilities, socially and economically vulnerable children. Particularly, it is expected to maintain universal inclusion and accessibility of preschool education: accessibility of inclusive and quality preschool education for all children of 3-6 age including children in need of special educational conditions, and maximum engagement of children at age 5.

2.2 Universal primary and secondary education

Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide "12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory."

Primary education

- Is primary education compulsory in your country?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Please indicate the current duration period of compulsory education and the age of enrolment:

In this part, you may also provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government in the realization of universal access to primary education. Quantitative information could be added.

Pursuant to the laws of the Republic of Armenia "On education" and "On general education", elementary education, being the first degree of secondary education, is free of charge and compulsory. Until 2015, the basic general education was compulsory, but on 8 April 2015 amendments were made to the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On general

education", by virtue of which part 4 of Article 4 of the Law was amended to read as follows:

"4. Secondary education shall be compulsory, except for the cases prescribed by law.

5. Secondary education shall be free of charge at state education institutions.

6. A 12-year secondary education shall be provided in the Republic of Armenia".

The provision of the law, which stipulates the requirement of compulsory secondary education, entered into force on 1 June, 2017, before which basic education will be considered mandatory.

Pursuant to the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On general education", the basic programmes of general education shall be formed according to the principles of succession and continuity. They shall be classified as follows:

the 1st degree — elementary/primary (4 years);

the 2nd degree — basic (9 years) ;

the 3rd degree — secondary (12 years).

Thus, the 2nd degree of general education, i.e. basic education, comprises also elementary education.

Admission to the first grade of school is open for those children who have reached the age of six or are due on December 31 of the given calendar year.

The highest enrolment of learners is at the level of elementary education — 91,1%.

The rate for the indicator of students' gender equality at the level of primary education was 1.01.

In the academic year of 2018-2019, 98-80% of students positively passed the final exams at the primary school. In 2018, the share of children finishing the primary school, who obtained at least the minimum level of knowledge from reading and mathematics, was 88.24% (boys: 88.27%, girls: 88.19%).

According to the UNESCO Institute for Statistics, the participation rate in organized learning (by sex), one year before the official primary entry age made 47.5% in 2018 (boys 45.8%, girls 49.5%).

This indicator is, in fact, important, and reflects the enrollment of children in programs preparing them for school. The higher this figure, the smoother the transition of students from kindergarten to school.

This may be explained by the fact that literacy of learners develops mainly in elementary schools.

Pursuant to the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On education" (HO-297-N), the requirement for the basic general education to be compulsory remains for learners under the age of 16 and the twelve-year secondary education may be realised before the learner attains the age of 19, if this right has not been exercised earlier.

- Is primary education available free of charge to all?

☒ Yes: Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is.

For this, please list the laws and policies that ensure the universal and free availability of primary education and indicate whether direct and indirect costs are charged (such as tuition fees, exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport costs and compulsory levies on parents).

Secondary education is free of charge in all educational institutions of the Republic of

Armenia offering general education programmes.

Secondary education includes primary and secondary education .

At the same time, in the academic year of 2018-2019, 98.76% of students passed their final exams at the level of basic education, and 99.38% at the level of high schools.

At the expense of the state budget the state provides to primary school students with textbooks designed for basic general education programs. There is no mandated school uniform, so it is the parents who buy it. The transportation expenses of the students from rural regional settlements of RA (for whom the nearest school is located in an area more than 5 km away from their place of residence) are reimbursed at the expense of the RA state budget. In this tier of schooling there are no mandatory fees for students attending RA public schools.

☐ No: Is your country already engaged in legal and policy reforms to work towards universal and free primary education?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please briefly provide information on the reforms taken:

Secondary education

In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training in your country.

- Is secondary education (middle/high) available free of charge?

☒ Yes: Please provide the duration and describe the extent to which it is.

Please list the laws and policies that ensure the free availability of secondary education and describe whether direct and indirect costs are covered (such as tuition fees, exam fees, school supplies, uniforms, transport costs and compulsory levies on parents).

Pursuant to the laws of the Republic of Armenia "On education" and "On general education" the 12-year secondary education in state educational institutions is free of charge.

However, families incur additional educational expenses for the education of their children which include the purchase of textbooks, school supplies and transport expenses but generally, this is not a major problem for families at the levels of elementary and secondary education. However, these additional educational expenses are a *heavy* burden for poor families and especially for those having children studying at higher grades. Besides, in order to enter a higher education institution after completing high school, most of the learners often take private classes/lessons which also require expenses from the families.

Thus, according to the learners, the two main reasons/arguments for failing to continue studies in high school after graduating from basic school are the completion of the basic education and the social standing of the family (or high tuition fees).

From the RA state budget funds areas provided for the reimbursement of the rent of

textbooks for children from socially vulnerable families and 38 bordering communities, as well as for the transportation expenses of students from rural settlements in the regions of the Republic of Armenia (for whom the nearest school is located in an area more than 5 km away from their place of residence).

- ☐ No: What are the measures your government intends to take to ensure free secondary education?

- Is secondary education (middle/high) compulsory in your country?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide details on its implementation and indicate the duration of compulsory secondary education and the age of enrolment:

In this part, you may also provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government in the realization of universal access to secondary education. Quantitative information could be added.

Secondary education lasts 12 years. Children are admitted to school from the age of 6. Concurrently, in 2018 the enrolment picture at different levels of education is as follows: gross enrolment ratio at school of general education comprised 83.0%; moreover at elementary school it comprised 91.1%, at basic school —89.4%, at high school — 59.9%.

The rate for the students' gender equality in secondary education was 1.04, specifically at the level of primary education (grades 1-4) it was 1.01, at the level of basic education (grades 1-9) it was 1.01, and on the level of high schools (grades 10-12) it was 1.20.

As it has already been mentioned, the highest enrolment of pupils is at the level of elementary education — 91.1%. The enrolment in the system of basic education has slightly decreased comprising 89.4% and is homogeneous in terms of territory, gender and poverty groups and there have been no significant disparities in this regard. The gross enrolment rate at high schools is relatively low, comprising 59.9%. After graduating from basic school, the majority of the population of the appropriate age continued their education in primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education institutions.

The secondary education is compulsory for all, except for cases prescribed by law, and probably this is the reason why the enrolment rate in basic schools is high. Thus, in general, it can be noted that all groups of the population have access to basic education and there have been no significant disparities in this regard. Therefore, enrolment of almost all children in basic schools is guaranteed in Armenia.

The following actions will be taken to make general education universally available:

- The universal inclusive education system will be expanded and introduced in all regions of Armenia, and
- Transportation costs for students from rural areas (for whom the nearest school is located in an area more than 5 km away from their place of residence) will

continue to be reimbursed.

- provision of free of charge textbooks and study materials to the pupils of elementary grades as well as to the socially disadvantaged children will continue;
- the scopes of School Meals Programme will be expanded by involving larger number of pupils from elementary schools, etc.

Simultaneously, cooperation with a number of international organisations implementing programmes aimed at social protection of learners, will continue.

In the field of Primary vocational (handicraft) education-

Instruction has been carried out on the basis of basic and secondary education. The gross enrolment ratio of students has made up 6.7% (3.9% of women and 9.2% of men), the Gender Equality Index — 0.42.

In the field of Secondary vocational education-

Instruction has been carried out on the basis of basic and secondary education. The gross enrolment ratio of students has made up 11.7% (13.1% of women and 10.7% of men), the Gender Equality Index — 1.26.

Since 2012-2013 academic year, the number of seats in free of charge instruction system (full refund of tuition fees in the form of allowance) of educational institutions implementing primary (handicraft) and secondary vocational education programmes has generally increased by 50%.

At the same time, before 2011, admission to state and accredited non-state secondary vocational institutions was carried out on a competitive basis through admission examinations. With the aim to enhance attractiveness of secondary vocational education and enrolment of learners at this level of education, since 2011-2012 academic year admission has been carried out without admission examinations, except for the professions pertaining to the fields of art, healthcare and sports, in case whereof professional examination shall be taken. The competition-based admission (including primary vocational (handicraft)) is carried out on the basis of the arithmetical average of the grades in the graduation document and the total sum of the grades in the subjects considered to be competitive for the given profession.

As a result of the above mentioned activities, enrolment at primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education level has generally increased in the recent years.

This implies that certain proportion of pupils of high schools and graduates of secondary school have preferred to continue their education at the vocational education level, which proves the efficiency of the implemented policy. Besides, at this level of primary vocational education, the number of boys prevails, whereas at the secondary vocational education level there are no substantial gender differences.

At the same time, efforts aimed at ensuring continuity of the learners' education and revising the content of education, modernising professions, encouraging learners and other activities have continued to be made at this level of vocational education. In particular:

procedure for admission and secondment of citizens of bordering or high mountainous settlements to education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, carrying out primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education programmes, as well as the list of professions establishing certain privileges for citizens of bordering or high mountainous settlements were approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 651-N of 12 June 2014; the process of transition from secondary vocational education institutions to higher education institutions has been facilitated. Pursuant to the Law of the Republic of

Armenia (HO-17-N) "On making amendments and a supplement to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On education'" adopted on 5 June 2014, graduates of secondary vocational education institutions, having shown high academic performance, may continue their education in higher education institutions under relevant profession – in the second year – through distance learning;
the lists of vocational education and training professions have been revised by bringing them in line with the requirements of labour market, National framework of qualifications (NFQ) and UNESCO classification of occupations.

- Indicate whether your country has adopted and reviewed legislation related to the minimum age of entry into employment so that it is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

Please note that minimum age labour laws and those related to compulsory education interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions:

According to Article 17, Part 2, Clause 2.2 of the RA Labor Code, «Persons under the age of fourteen may be engaged in creation of works (creative work) and/or performance thereof in cinematographic, sports, theatrical and concert organisations, circuses, television and radio companies upon written consent of one of the parents/guardian/adopter or of the guardianship and custody body which must not cause harm to their health and morals, as well as must not interfere with their education or safety.

Persons between the ages of fourteen and eighteen may not be engaged in work on weekends, non-working days — holidays and memorial days — except when participating in sporting and cultural events.

A temporary employment contract shall be concluded with persons under the age of 16». The mentioned provisions of the Code have remained unchanged.

2.3 Higher education

Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3⁸, and target 4.4⁹.

- Please indicate the measures adopted to ensure that there is no discrimination on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation¹⁰ to enter and complete higher

⁸ Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”.

⁹ Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

¹⁰ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

education, including technical and vocational education and training (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

☒ Constitutional laws and/or legislation prohibit discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training

☒ Regulations prohibit discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training

☐ Policies and programs aim to eliminate and prevent discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training

☐ Other:

- Please provide a brief description of the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts including measures on:

➔ *Non-discrimination in the admission of students to higher education institutions on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation*

➔ *Non-differential treatment, including of foreign students*

Amendments to the Constitution of the Republic of Armenia were adopted on 6 December 2015. The following provision on discrimination is enshrined in Article 29: "Discrimination based on sex, race, skin colour, ethnic or social origin, genetic features, language, religion, world view, political or other views, affiliation to a national minority, property status, birth, disability, age, or personal or social circumstances shall be prohibited." The right to education is enshrined in Article 38: "Everyone shall have the right to education. The programmes of compulsory education and the duration thereof shall be prescribed by law. Secondary education in state education institutions shall be free of charge. Everyone shall, in the cases and in the manner prescribed by law, have the right to free of charge education on a competitive basis in state higher and other vocational education institutions. Higher education institutions shall, to the extent prescribed by law, have the right to self-governance, including academic freedom and freedom of research".

The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-297) "On education" was adopted on 14 April 1999, which, based on the constitutional provisions, to a certain extent, guides the development of the education system. This Law stipulates state guarantees for the right to education, pursuant to which: "The Republic of Armenia shall ensure the right to education, regardless of the nationality, race, gender, language, belief, political or other views, social origin, property status or other circumstances." The legal equality of women and men has also been provided for in this Law.

- Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”.

☐ Higher education is generally free of charge

☒ Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience

☒ Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships

☒ Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures

☒ Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate on the measures taken and provide brief information on the financial costs to receive education in higher public or private education institutions, if higher education is not free of charge.

In this part, you may also provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government as regards access to higher education and on the progress realized. Quantitative information could be added.

Gross enrolment ratio in the first level degree of higher professional education comprised 52.2% (56.6% of women and 48.2% of men), the Gender Equality Index — 1.17.

The gross enrolment ratio in the second level degree of higher professional education comprised 14.1 % (19.4% of women and 8.9% of men), the Gender Equality Index— 14.1.

In recent years, the enrollment of students in these two levels of higher education has increased.

However, the number of PhD students has comparatively decreased. In 2018 it was 985 people, 57.5% of whom were female.

The higher professional education in Armenia is provided in state and non-state higher professional education institutions (including accredited) on a free of charge and fee paid basis.

Legislation on higher education of the Republic of Armenia is mainly regulated by the Laws of the Republic of Armenia "On education" and "On higher and postgraduate professional education" as well as secondary legislative acts deriving therefrom.

Law and separate regulations prescribe the minimum requirements for admission to all the three levels of higher education institution, unified graduation and admission examinations according to the professions and universities.

For certain socially vulnerable groups — taking also into consideration the academic performance of a student — admission and education in higher education institutions are organised under privileged conditions to ensure access to higher education for all the citizens. This is regulated by the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On higher and postgraduate professional education" and the Procedure for granting student allowances

and state stipends in higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, as well as internal regulations of higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, which must not contradict to the norms prescribed by law. Pursuant to Article 6 of the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On higher and postgraduate professional education":

"The higher education institution shall, at its own expense and in the amount of at least seven per cent of the budget generated from the tuition fees of students, taking as a basis the high academic performance and the social group, partially refund, in the form of student allowances, the tuition fees of at least ten per cent of the students studying in fee paid instruction system – for the students holding the following status:

- (1) socially disadvantaged students (those from families falling under the grade with one point higher than the marginal grade of socially disadvantaged condition of families) — in the amount of at least 30 per cent;
- (2) students left without parental care after attaining the age of 18 — until they attain the age of 23 — in the amount of at least 50 per cent;
- (3) students having been deprived of one parent (having one parent) and having not attained the age of 23 — in the amount of at least 50 per cent;
- (4) students having a child under the age of 1 — in the amount of at least 50 per cent;
- (5) students from families with three and more minors or three and more students — in the amount of at least 30 per cent;
- (6) students having a disabled parent of 1st or 2nd group, including a disabled parent considered as a freedom fighter — in the amount of at least 30 per cent;
- (7) students having passed compulsory fixed-term military service and engaged in combat duty at military units carrying out combat duty — at least 30 per cent;
- (8) socially disadvantaged students (from families falling under any grade higher than the grade of 0 kept on records in the evaluation system of socially disadvantaged condition of families) — at least 20 per cent;
- (9) students holding other status, which may be defined by the higher education institution".

Rotation evaluation system is being implemented in the higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, which enables the students, having shown the best academic performance in the year, to study on a free of charge basis. Free of charge seats are also provided to the student studying in target spheres.

On April 23, 2020 (entered into force on September 1, 2020) amendments were made to the RA Government Decision N 1403-N of November 29, 2007, as a result of which the amount of scholarships given to PhD students was increased by 35,000 AMD, making 65.000 AMD for Armenian studies students, 60.000 AMD for Science students, 55.000 AMD for Economics and Law students, as well as 65.000 AMD for Doctoral students.

As a social support, based on the regulations for granting student allowances and state scholarships in universities, the state reimbursed 50-100% of tuition fees of about 2230 socially vulnerable students, and for 917 students from families living in border or remote mountainous areas.

Number of students who received reimbursement in 2019 was 3147. Amount of money is 654 million AMD, 525 million of which was paid to socially vulnerable students.

According to the Government Decision N 1464 of December 13, 2019 tuition fees of 25 full-time Undergraduate students in State Universities with two or more children were fully reimbursed.

The process of providing nominal scholarships to students with the best academic achievement in universities has continued. According to the decree of the Minister of

Education, Science, Culture and Sports, 38 winner students from 7 fields (Natural sciences (including Mathematical-information-communication technologies (ICT)), Medicine, Humanities, Social Sciences, Engineering (including Architectural/Agricultural), Culture-sports, Armenian Studies were awarded annual nominal scholarships.

In addition to the above mentioned, the citizens of the Republic of Armenia — for the purpose of studying in the higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia — are also supported by the Youth Foundation of Armenia, as well as a number of other foundations financing education of the students of Armenian nationality (including Armenian General Benevolent Union, Hrayr and Anna Hovnanian Foundation). Credit funds, provided through state subsidies by the commercial banks and credit organisations of the Republic of Armenia, are also available as a financial support with an interest rate of 12-15%, 2-3% out of which is subsidised by the state according to the academic performance of the student, and are provided upon the recommendation letter of parents/guardians and for the purpose of studying in state and non-state higher education institutions.

Pursuant to the Procedure for admission of foreign nationals, as well as members of families of diplomats working in the diplomatic service bodies of the Republic of Armenia, operating in a foreign state, to higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 700-N of 28 April 2011, making education in the higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia accessible for foreigners and organising for them instruction either in literary Armenian or foreign languages is guaranteed. Pursuant to the mentioned procedure, admission of the foreign nationals to the higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia is not carried out on a competitive basis; the number of fee paid seats is not limited either. Performed knowledge checks are only aimed to assess proficiency in the Armenian language and other subjects defined for admission in order to direct the applicant either to the first year or to the preparation course.

No cases of obvious inequality between women's and men's rights, substantially considered as a possible violation of law, have been recorded so far.

Issues related to students' accommodation, health and rest conditions are also important. With regard to the students from regions studying in the higher education institutions of the capital, the state provides state grants to 200 students in total, as a result the students are able to solve the problem of accommodation with little rental fee. At the same time, students are provided with dormitories at discounted prices. However, this is not enough to meet the students' demand for accommodation. Therefore, in order to solve the accommodation problem, students have to rent apartments which are rather expensive even in the suburbs of the capital (the average price for renting an apartment is AMD 107.000).

There are first aid rooms necessarily functioning in all higher education institutions for the purpose of providing first aid to students. Besides, there is a student medical clinic in Yerevan which renders a relevant service to the students of a given higher education institution within the framework of contracts signed with the higher education institutions.

Most of the state higher education institutions have, under their subordination, operating institutions for organising leisure, where the students of the given higher education institution may spend their holidays at a low price. Moreover, higher education institutions also provide free of charge holiday tickets to socially disadvantaged students

having shown high academic performance.

As a result of the above mentioned activities, enrolment at the highest professional education level has generally increased in the recent years. This is to state that the reforms made in the field of higher education resulted in the increase of targeting.

In spite of the above mentioned regulations, the higher education system in the Republic of Armenia still faces a problem with increasing access, which is mainly conditioned by insufficient financial resources. To solve this problem, it is envisaged to increase the portion for higher education in the Gross Domestic Product of the Republic of Armenia, introduce a mechanism for financing — based on performance — of state higher education institutions, increase allocations for providing funding for the costs of education of students, diversify the sources and instruments of financing, improve conditions in dormitory, create new dormitory complexes and promote instruction in a foreign language, ensure affordability and accessibility of higher education for different social groups and for persons in need of special conditions for education.

At the same time, steps have been taken to increase the number and amount of scholarships of Armenian citizens sent to foreign universities and foreign students studying in Armenian universities within the framework of interstate agreements. As of January 2020, within the framework of the Erasmus+ program 74 Armenian students are studying in 17 countries. Within the framework of interstate agreements, 101 places have been allocated for higher and postgraduate education in Armenia for students from 12 countries of the world, and 109 places for studying in those countries from Armenia. Within the framework of interstate agreements, the University faculty has opportunity to participate in training programs.

Considering that Distance learning is now spreading not only in Armenia but all over the world as a form of non-formal education, steps are being taken to make e-learning available throughout Armenia. At present, the courses organized by educational institutions with different means of telecommunication and in different educational platforms, the preparation and broadcasting of TV programmes, the implementation of lectures, lesson preparations and other teaching processes using computer and mobile applications have become applicable in Armenia.

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning

Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.”

- Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- ☐ Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education
- ☐ Provision of literacy programmes

- ☐ Provision of appropriate learning and life-skills programmes
- ☐ Provision of free of charge learning opportunities
- ☒ Provision of flexible learning pathways
- ☒ Provision of professional training and qualifications
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

According to the 12-year education system, the child starts attending school from the age of 6. However, the Procedure for admission to, transfer from and removal of a learner from a general education institution of the Republic of Armenia regulates also the enrolment in school of those children who, for different reasons, have not attended school on time.

In compliance with the referred procedure, children above 16 not having attended school may master the general education programmes through self-education and as an external student obtain a basic education certificate (or academic certificate of secondary education). Pursuant to the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On making amendments to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On education'" (HO-20-N) of 8 April 2015, 12-year secondary education in the Republic of Armenia may be realised before the learner attains the age of 19, if this right has not been exercised earlier.

The term "education of adults" has been used in the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education". The Law provides for the implementation of education of adults along with other educational programmes within primary vocational and secondary vocational education institutions. In this context, short-term (1-6 months) educational programmes are also implemented at primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education institutions for professions in demand in the labour market. Persons having completed those courses are granted a completion document, namely a certificate.

As of 2019, 26 out of 97 institutions implementing preliminary (craftsmanship) and vocational education programs have been completed 99 short-term vocational training programs have been completed. Nine hundred eighty-three people participated in the program.

In 2020, in 46 preliminary (craftsmanship) and vocational is planned to implement 123 short-term vocational training programs. The number of participants will be 1858, according to the plan.

The following essential provision has been enshrined in the Procedure for admission to state and non-state higher vocational education institutions of the Republic of Armenia of the Government of the Republic of Armenia N 597-N of 26 April 2012: "Persons with secondary education, primary vocational education or secondary vocational education may be admitted to higher education institutions without any age limit."

Since it is impossible to ensure the harmonious development of a person and his or her competitiveness in the labour market only through a formal education system in the

current rapidly changing social-economic conditions, the regulation of the field of supplementary and continuing education, the assessment and recognition of knowledge, abilities and skills gained through non-formal and informal training have become important in Armenia, as well as in many European countries.

As a comparatively newly established direction in the system of education in the Republic of Armenia, the field of supplementary and continuing education is in need of reforms, particularly improvement of the legal framework. As a result of the study of the current situation in this field and analysis thereof, the Strategy and Action Plan for Supplementary and Continuing Education in the Republic of Armenia have been approved by Order of the Minister of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia N 1163-A/Q of 20 December 2012.

And the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On making supplements and amendments to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On education'" (HO-83-N) was adopted on 21 June 2014, which served as a ground for the approval of the Procedure for organising and implementing supplementary education programmes and the Procedure for assessment and recognition of the results of non-formal and informal instruction, prescribed by points 1 and 2 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia N 1062-N of 10 September 2015.

In implementing the approved procedures, each person, irrespective of national, religious or racial affiliation or educational degree, will have the right to make his or her knowledge, abilities and skills gained by any means (non-formal, informal), recognised by the State, as well as benefit from the supplementary education programmes offered by natural and legal persons guaranteed by the State in order to be competitive in the labour market and be employed.

For the purpose of disseminating the ideology of supplementary and continuing education and raising awareness about the current policy, an information guide and methodical manual entitled "Supplementary and Continuing Education" have been drafted, a team of trainers has been formed, which conducts courses based on a training manual with representatives of primary vocational and secondary vocational education institutions of Yerevan and of all provinces of the Republic of Armenia implementing supplementary education programmes, territorial employment agencies and employers.

In the context of ensuring interrelation between the labour market and the educational system, the "Concept Paper on Development of Professional Orientation in the Republic of Armenia" approved by point 1 of Protocol Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia N 40 of 4 October 2012 proposes to introduce such a model of professional orientation system, the essential basis of which will be the ensuring of opportunities for the effective selection, change of profession and continuing development of a career for persons in different age groups and in different social and working situations throughout their whole lives, taking into consideration the personal attributes of a person, as well as the changing situation of the labour market. The exclusion of any type of discrimination in regard to professional orientation is singled out in the main principles for the introduction of the system.

In the presented model, the main levels providing services are the system of general education, primary vocational (handicraft), secondary vocational and higher professional education, as well as the territorial employment centres, the institutes for the selection of a profession, career guidance, re-specialisation and requalification that are out of the educational system. An objective has been set to enhance the existing Methodical Centre for Professional Orientation and reserve the ensuring of methodologies and training of specialists of the structures of the system to it.

The "Career Management" modular programme has been drafted and is envisaged to be introduced at vocational education and training institutions as an optional subject. From 2013 till now, the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia, jointly with the "Methodical Centre for Professional Orientation" SNCO and with the support of the European Foundation for Education, has carried out activities for the introduction and exploitation of career centres at 22 vocational education and training institutions. Higher education institutions have also established career centres, the main goal whereof is to strengthen the bonds between the labour market and the higher education institution and support students in their internships and alumni in finding jobs.

The "Methodical Centre for Professional Orientation" SNCO also greatly supports to learners of the 9th year of basic school and those of high schools with respect to professional orientation. The supporting manual "Disciplinary Work in School: Problems of Professional Orientation" and the relevant modules of the manual (for each age group) have been published for supervising teachers. Every year, the Centre conducts training courses for deputy directors for specialised assistance and supervising teachers in a certain number of general education schools of the marzes of the Republic of Armenia and in Yerevan. Learners are informed about professional orientation issues during the classes of the supervising teachers.

One of the 14 annual programmes carried out by the State Employment Agency through the State Budget of the Republic of Armenia within the scope of state employment support programmes is the programme "Organising of Professional (Vocational) Instruction for Unemployed Persons and Job Seekers Facing the Risk of Dismissal", the goal of which is to ensure stable employment by preparing specialists in accordance with the demands of the labour market and by raising the level of their competitiveness in the labour market. Beneficiaries of the programme are unemployed persons and job seekers facing the risk of dismissal. Professional (vocational) preparation (primary vocational preparation and handicraft instruction) is organised within the framework of the programme for up to 6 months, and re-specialisation and raising of qualification – for up to 3 months. A stipend is paid to the job seeker engaged in the professional (vocational) training courses every month during the whole period of the training. At least 11% of those included in the programme are expected to be persons with disabilities.

2.5 Quality education provision and learning environment

Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to “build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all”.

- Please indicate the measures taken by your country to ensure equivalence in all educational institutions with regard to (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

☒ Establishment of minimum norms and standards in education

- ✓ Establishment of conditions relating to the quality of the education provided (e.g. infrastructure, learner/teacher ratios, teaching and learning materials, use of ICT)
- ✓ Adoption of legal or regulatory provisions to ensure that children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools).

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

To provide such quality assessment, please take into account all educational institutions of the same level. You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.

Pursuant to the Law of the Republic of Armenia “On education”, “State educational standards shall be established and promulgated in the Republic of Armenia, which shall be deemed as the basis for assessment of education level and qualification of graduates, irrespective of the form of education they have received as well as legal and organisational form of educational institutions”.

Uniform state educational standards shall be established for educational programmes implemented at different levels of education in the Republic of Armenia. State standards of secondary education, higher and postgraduate professional education shall be established by the Government of the Republic of Armenia. State standards of secondary vocational education shall be established by the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia. Ensuring compliance with the requirements of state educational standards is compulsory for both state, as well as private/non-state education institutions.

In 2019, the Ministry of Education, Science, Culture, and Sports of the Republic of Armenia started reviewing the State Standards of School Education and Subject Standards. Last time STEM (Science, Engineering, ICT/Computer Science, Mathematics, and Geography) and Humanities standards were revised 15 years ago.

State standards for STEM subjects are being reviewed under the EU-funded Innovation Program in Armenia. Humanities standards are being reviewed under the World Bank's Education Improvement Program's "Improving the Quality of Public Education through Reviewing the National Curriculum and Standards" Sub-Program.

Due to the reforms under the Bologna and Turin Processes, educational standards were revised in the field of professional education as well. The new standards are targeted at improvement of the quality of professional education, capacity building for personnel training in compliance with the demands of the labour market and European standards.

The State Inspectorate for Education was established in 2005 for the purpose of evaluating the efficiency of implementation of educational programmes, exercising state supervision over the quality assurance of education within educational institutions and other organisations implementing general education programmes and primary vocational (handicraft) education programmes.

Licensing is deemed as a process of official authorisation of educational activities of an educational institution. The education programmes provided for by law may be implemented only in case of availability of a licence — a document certifying the right to official authorisation. The licence is issued to an educational institution in case of meeting the following requirements: availability of main pedagogical and/or academic and teaching staff, laboratory base and teaching space, teaching and methodical support, library and information system, educational internship base.

With a view of rendering an opinion on licensing of education programmes of educational institutions, Licensing Agency was established and currently operates within the staff of

the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia upon point 1 of the Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 676-N of 12 May 2011.

The Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia has undertaken the improvement of licensing process and several legal acts have been adopted having their aim to exercise supervision over the compliance with the conditions and requirements of licences for the activities carried out under higher professional education programmes and to impose sanctions in case of failure of complying therewith. In its turn, it has fostered the responsibility for educational activities carried out in the field of higher education by considerably raising the effectiveness of handling the problems existing in the higher education system.

In accordance with the Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 18-N of 10 January 2013 the applications on licensing and reports may be submitted by licensed persons to the licensing body also through an electronic system, which facilitates the implementation of licensing process by interested organisations by considerably simplifying the licensing process and making the field more transparent.

The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-84-N) “On making amendments to the Law of the Republic of Armenia “On licensing”” was adopted on 19 June 2013, which was conditioned by the current reforms in the field of education and is aimed at implementing the principles of Bologna process. The educational institutions carrying out professional medical education programmes pursue their educational activities upon laws and legal acts regulating the field, as well as implement education programmes by ensuring the instruction of learners in compliance with the requirements of these programmes. However, by 2015, the authorisation of educational activities (licence) was issued by another agency (Ministry of Health of the Republic of Armenia). Hereinafter, the licensing process is being implemented out by the Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sport of the Republic of Armenia also in respect of medical professions.

The aim of the amendments to the law is to have single state policy, single standards of state policy in the field of education, as well as to ensure equal framework for licensing conditions and requirements for educational institutions, which will foster responsibility for educational activities carried out in the field of education by considerably raising the effectiveness of handling problems existing in the professional education system.

“National Centre for Professional Education Quality Assurance Foundation” (ANCA) was established upon point 1 of the Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1486-N of 27 November 2008. Starting from 2015, higher professional education institutions of the Republic of Armenia started receiving accreditation by ANCA. ANCA holds full and associate membership in International Network for Quality Assurance Agencies Of Higher Education (INQAAHE) and European Association for Quality Assurance Of Higher Education (ENQA) respectively. It has its aim of fostering international recognition of the quality of higher education of the Republic of Armenia and ensuring the competitiveness thereof. The graduation documents issued by higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia accredited by ANCA are recognised by the European Higher Education Area (EHEA). ANCA is in charge of external quality assessment and quality assurance of higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia.

EU TEMPUS and TWINNING programmes have key role in improvement of quality of education within the framework whereof all actors of higher education system of the Republic of Armenia manage to improve, upon active exchange of experience and joint

activities with EHEA countries, the infrastructures of the higher education system of the Republic of Armenia and receive an opportunity of undergoing training in order to work under EHEA standards. In 2011-2012, internal quality assurance centres have been established within higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia.

In 2015 the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia, with the support of Council of Europe (CoE), within the framework of “Strengthening Integrity and Combating Corruption in Higher Education in Armenia” project and jointly with the expert group and higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, elaborated model ethics codes (rules of conduct) and guidelines for the development thereof, which will enable the higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia to develop own rules of conduct with a view of strengthening integrity within higher education. When describing certain values in the model form, ‘non-discrimination’ and ‘discrimination’ expressions were stressed, as was the case with descriptions of values of ‘fairness’, ‘impartiality, justice and social justice’, ‘respect for others’. These values (principles) and the remainder of those included in the model form are mainly based on the elaboration of Pan-European Platform on Ethics, Transparency and Integrity in Education (ETINED) of the Council of Europe and on two documents constituting a part of initiative on this platform — Ethical Principles (for Education) and Ethical Behaviour of All Actors in Education (Smith and Hamilton, 2015). The aforementioned principles and documents have been considered during elaboration of the new Draft Law of the Republic of Armenia “On higher education”.

In 2014, “Ethical Norms for Teachers” was elaborated and introduced in all general education schools of the Republic of Armenia.

2.6 Education personnel

Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- ☒ Teachers’ average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels)
- ☒ Initial training and continuous professional development is provided
- ☒ Minimum standards and qualifications are required for the teaching profession
- ☐ Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession
- ☐ Performance monitoring systems
- ☐ Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education
- ☐ Other:

- Please briefly elaborate further on the measures taken:

The Government of the Republic of Armenia undertakes continuous measures aimed at improving the professionalism of pedagogues, public standing thereof and raising the attractiveness of the profession of a teacher. According to the Law of the Republic of Armenia “On education” “The remuneration rate for the work carried out by pedagogical (academic and teaching) staff at state education institutions may not be lower than the average salary of employees of budgetary institutions”. This requirement of the Law of the Republic of Armenia “On education” is ensured in the field of professional education. Professional education institutions provide the academic and teaching staff with increments at the expense of funds received from their paid instruction systems.

A policy on increasing the salaries of pedagogues is implemented for the purpose of increasing the interest in the profession of pedagogue and improving the quality of education in the field of general education.

In September 2019, teachers' salaries were increased by 10%, and since January 2020, the concept of a teacher's minimum salary, regardless of the number of students, was fixed.

Each year, “Best Teacher of the Year”, “Best Principal of the Year” and “Best Educator of the Year” contests are organised; the best candidates are granted with awards by the Prime Minister of the Republic of Armenia and the Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sport of the Republic of Armenia.

Armenia participates in EU eTwinning project wherein teachers from Armenian schools, specialised in different subjects, act very actively and show good results. Online events, forums and contests are organised with cooperating schools in abroad.

In accordance with Article 50 of the Law of the Republic of Armenia “On education” adopted in 1999, The Government of the Republic of Armenia has defined additional remuneration for teachers of general education schools in borderline, highland and mountainous settlements.

The system of granting qualification grades through competence evaluation of teachers of general education institutions is introduced upon point 3 of the Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1745-N of 10 November 2011, which enables teachers to receive increments for the creative work performed thereby and active professional activities thereof.

Continuous works are implemented with regard to raising the organisational and financial autonomy, accountability, effectiveness of management of higher education institutions. Within the framework of this process state higher education institutions have changed their legal and organisational form by becoming a foundation from the state of SNCO. This change implies also development of entrepreneurial activities in higher education institutions, in the result whereof the higher education institution will become more independent and will have an opportunity to maintain close contacts with the private sector, to improve the quality of education by combining education, research and practical work.

In line with the introduction of the 12-year system of education, training of teachers implemented in the regions of the Republic of Armenia and in the city of Yerevan at the expense of State Budget of the Republic of Armenia. The training programme included topics on computer literacy, new education programmes, legislation, inclusive education, system of assessment and new teaching methods (80 hours). In recent years the pedagogical staff makes use of the social package designed for state servants of the

Republic of Armenia.

The Procedure “For training of lecturers of educational institutions implementing primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education programmes and that of masters of practical instruction” has been approved upon the Order of the Minister of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia No 1058-N of 29 October 2014. Pursuant to the existing procedure trainings for lectures and masters of practical instruction have been implemented, which were attended by teaching staff from all state education institutions of the system.

For the purpose of supporting the education centres of Diaspora and contributing to the preservation of Armenian identity, the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia and the Ministry of Diaspora of the Republic of Armenia carried out intensive instruction of Armenian language, training courses for teachers of Armenian language and history, team leaders and dancing-masters, within the framework of “Diaspora” Summer School Programme.

Thus, the choice of a profession is free and learners choose the profession of a pedagogue based on their preferences and abilities.

Therefore, the participation in training courses for pedagogues does not presume any discrimination; trainings are designed for all practising pedagogues.

At the same time, Teach for Armenia organization is playing an essential role in terms of staffing schools with teachers. As part of the program, the participants of the Leadership Development Program travel to remote villages, where they start teaching in schools with a shortage of teachers, thus contributing to the improvement of education quality. The teachers sent to these villages receive additional monetary compensation. Teachers working in rural schools, which are located more than 5 km away, also receive compensation.

- Have there been instances of discrimination as regards the training for education personnel in your country?

☐ Yes: Has your government addressed this issue?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☒ No

2.7 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.¹¹ Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.

¹¹

Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”.

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

☒ Curriculum includes human rights education

☒ Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education

☐ Other:

2.8 Private education

Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for private education.

- Does your country have a regulatory framework relating to the establishment and functioning of private educational institutions?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide a brief description:

Pursuant to the Law of the Republic of Armenia “On education”, “State educational standards shall be established and promulgated in the Republic of Armenia, which shall be deemed as the basis for assessment of education level and qualification of graduates, irrespective of the form of education they have received as well as legal and organisational form of educational institutions”.

Uniform state educational standards shall be established for educational programmes implemented at different levels of education in the Republic of Armenia. State standards of secondary education, higher and postgraduate professional education shall be established by the Government of the Republic of Armenia. State standards of secondary vocational education shall be established by the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia. Ensuring compliance with the requirements of state educational standards is compulsory for both state, as well as private/non-state education institutions.

- Do legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation¹² explicitly apply to private educational institutions?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Please briefly describe what laws, regulations or policies guarantee that the development of private education does not generate discrimination and that private schools offer a relevant alternative in your country:

In the Law of the Republic of Armenia “On education” the principles of state policy on

education of the Republic of Armenia enshrine the following provisions:

- guaranteeing for citizens opportunities of receiving education in state and non-state education institutions;
- ensuring legally equal status of state and accredited non-state education institutions and that of graduation documents issued thereby.

Non-state education institutions are also available in the Republic of Armenia, wherein education services are also rendered on paid basis. The non-state education institutions may be established only as prescribed by law, whereas education programmes may be implemented therein only in case of availability of relevant licence. Non-state higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, accredited by the NCQA, acquire state-funded free of charge seats for instruction (as in case of state higher education institutions).

In state and non-state schools the standard requirements, syllabus requirements, as well as those to graduates are deemed as uniform and the same for all. Non-state schools implement also foreign, optional, authorial general education programmes which are prescribed by law and may not contradict the requirements for state standard of general education. Non-state general education institutions acquire the right to issue a state-recognised graduation document upon receiving relevant licence.

Secondary vocational and higher professional education institutions undergo accreditation process carried out as of the education institutions and professions thereof. Accreditation process provides an opportunity to create legally equal conditions for learners and graduates of state and non-state education institutions. A state final competence evaluation examination is organised for graduates of previous years having received education under secondary vocational and higher professional education programmes, as a result whereof a state-recognised diploma is issued.

In case of violating the conditions and requirements of licensing, the licence of the educational institution for implementing educational programmes may be withdrawn.

Procedure for admission to state and non-state higher education institutions (according to Bachelor's degree education programme), which was approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 597-N of 26 April 2012.

Admission to state and accredited non-state institutions of handicraft and secondary vocational education shall be carried out according to the admission procedure approved by the Order of the Minister of Education and Science for the given academic year.

"Ayb" school has a remarkable place in the educational system of Armenia. Teaching at Ayb School is provided by the Araratian Baccalaureate (AB) Armenian Educational Program, developed by the Ayb Educational Foundation. The AB is a world-class competitive, and demanding curriculum designed for modern public and private educational institutions. The AB is explicitly designed for Armenian schools, and the teaching is in Armenian. The AB program combines several core and elective subjects, including Mathematics, Science, History, Social Studies, Languages, and Art. A Fablab has been opened next to the school, a workshop-laboratory created by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology, where students apply the theory in practice.

The UWC College, which has an international reputation, operates in Dilijan, Armenia. UWC has 18 schools and colleges on four continents, most of which focus on the 16-19 age group. As part of the program, students from many countries have the opportunity to study for two years at a college, becoming the bearers of cultural exchange, unique experience, and quality education.

These schools, being the centers of excellence and differing in their status from public

schools, are legally equal to public schools (as are other non-public schools).

- Does your country have an education policy framework for minimum educational standards as regards the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children?

☒ Yes ☐ No

2.9 Rights of national minorities

Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities. National minorities, who often face language barriers, are among the specific groups referred to in the Convention.

- Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

☒ Constitutional laws and/or legislation protect the right to education of national minorities

☒ Legislation or regulations guarantee the right of national minorities to study in their mother tongue

☒ Curriculum is adapted to national minority needs

☐ Teachers are trained to adapt to national minority needs

☐ Other:

- Please provide a brief description of the provisions:

The Constitution of the Republic of Armenia is deemed as the main core element for implementation of state policy on the protection of the rights of persons holding affiliation to national minorities. In particular, pursuant to Article 38 of the amendments made to the Constitution of the Republic of Armenia adopted on 6 December 2015: "Everyone shall have the right to education. The programmes on and duration of compulsory education shall be prescribed by law. Secondary education in state education institutions shall be free of charge. Everyone shall, in the cases and under the procedure provided for by law, have the right to receive free education on a competitive basis in state higher and other vocational education institutions". While Article 56 states: "Everyone shall have the right to preserve his or her national and ethnic identity. Persons holding affiliation to national minorities shall have the right to preserve and develop their traditions, religion, language and culture".

- As regards the educational standards in educational institutions run by minorities, please describe the existing legal and policy framework:

Information could also cover the language facilities, such as the availability of teaching in the mother tongue of the students, use of teaching of languages in education policy, multilingualism, etc.

Pursuant to the Laws of the Republic of Armenia “On general education” and “On language”, the general education and upbringing in the communities of national minorities of the Republic of Armenia may be organised in their native language, within state programme and under state sponsorship, by compulsory instruction of the Armenian language”.

At the same time, pursuant to Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1392-N of 25 July 2002, in individual cases (at schools in mountainous, highland, borderline rural settlements, in urban and rural schools possessing classes in the languages of national minorities and in other cases) a class with less learners may be opened upon the authorisation of the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia. This Decision provides an opportunity of opening classes comprised of only Yezidi children in Yezidi-populated communities. Pursuant to the Procedure “For enrolment of a learner in an educational institution implementing basic general education programmes of the Republic of Armenia, for the transfer and dismissal of a learner from the institution, as well as for the organisation of education of children having been enrolled in general education later than the prescribed period”, approved by the Order of the Minister of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia No 400-N of 5 May 2016, the learner holding affiliation to a national minority is enrolled in school (class) providing an instruction of the national (native) language of the learner or in school (class) providing a course on that language, whereas in case of non-availability thereof — the parent of the learner selects the language of instruction.

Each year school textbooks are published and republished for the schools of national minorities, and regular trainings are conducted for teachers of the schools of national minorities.

Each year the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia approves model curriculum of general education schools (classes) of national minorities where class hours are allocated for studying native language, literature, culture and history of national minorities for the 1st-12th grades (41 class hours per week).

For the instruction of the subject entitled “Native Language and Literature” 4 class hours a week are allocated for 1st-5th grades each, and 3 class hours a week — for the 6th-12th grades each. Furthermore, in the settlements with mixed population where the number of national minorities is small, an opportunity of facultative instruction of language is envisaged. The instruction of Yezidi and Kurdish is carried out in elementary grades of the schools of rural areas resided by Yezidis and Kurds in case of availability of relevant specialist, irrespective of the number of children.

On the basis of preliminary applications submitted by the communities of national minorities residing in Armenia funds are allocated from the State Budget for the publication of textbooks.

Classes with the instruction of the Russian language operate in 42 general education schools for the population of Russian and Slavic national origin, where the instruction of general education subjects is carried out in Russian, except for the subjects entitled “Armenian language and literature” and the “History of Armenia”. Meanwhile, around 60 general education schools are available in the Republic, which provide advanced instruction of the Russian language: the Russian language is taught starting from the 1st grade. Special textbooks and methodological manuals have been published for these

schools. Textbooks recommended by the Ministry of Education and Science of the Russian Federation, as well as syllabuses recommended and approved by the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia are used at schools (classes) with the instruction of Russian language.

The applicants holding affiliation to national minorities of the Republic of Armenia are admitted to higher education institutions both on general grounds and based on the applications submitted by the heads of national minorities.

Subsequently, upon the motion of the Coordinating Council for National and Cultural Organisations of National Minorities of the Republic of Armenia, the higher education institutions apply full or partial discount of the tuition fee for students. It should be mentioned with regret that proper interest and motivation for higher professional education yet have not been developed among national minorities. With a view of raising awareness among them, particularly at the initiative of the Yezidi community, numerous events are organised aimed at increasing the focus by the Yezidis on the professional education, which are actively attended by the representatives of the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia.

The applicants holding affiliation to national minorities, who are admitted to state higher education institutions, avail of the privileges defined by the Law of the Republic of Armenia “On education”, including participation in the rotation process arranged at higher education institutions, as well as enjoy the right to discount of the tuition fee in the prescribed manner, are provided with state educational allowances, participate, as of their preferences and in the prescribed manner, in inter-higher education institution and intra- higher education institution exchange process, participate in the admission to Master’s Degree studies, etc.

2.10 Rights of refugees and migrants

The rights of refugees and migrants are not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the Convention and Recommendation call on states to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education based notably on national origin.¹³ In this context, a number of Member States that participated in the 9th Consultation reported on measures adopted to ensure refugees’ and migrants’ right to education. Growing displacement and influx of refugees worldwide and the emergence of major educational challenges in this area, as well as the frameworks recently adopted by the international community,¹⁴ demonstrate the opportunity for states to report on measures adopted to include refugees and migrants in their educational systems.

Besides, this aspect also corresponds to SDG target 4.5, which calls on states to “ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable”, including “children in vulnerable situations”, and covers the majority of SDG4 targets.

- Please briefly describe the existing legal and policy framework that protects the right to quality education for refugees and migrants in your country.

The admission of foreign nationals (including representatives of the Armenian Diaspora)

¹³ Articles/Paragraphs 1 and 3.

¹⁴ Namely the 2016 New York Declaration for Refugees and Migrants, the Comprehensive Refugee Response Framework and the two Global Compacts on refugees and for safe, orderly and regular migration.

to vocational education institutions of the Republic of Armenia is regulated by international treaties of the Republic of Armenia on co-operation in the sectors of education and science concluded between the Republic of Armenia and other states, as well as in accordance with the Procedure for admission of foreign nationals, as well as members of families of diplomats working in the diplomatic service bodies of the Republic of Armenia, operating in a foreign state, to higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 700-N of 28 April 2011, the Procedure for admission to primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1295-N of 25 August 2011.

The purpose of the existence of separate procedures for admission is to:

- make education at educational institutions of the Republic of Armenia accessible for foreign nationals;
- contribute to upbringing with the spirit of respect towards nations and mutual understanding, help spark interest among the youth in Armenian cultural heritage and contribute to the development of Armenian studies.

Foreign nationals having received secondary education in the Republic of Armenia and residing in Armenia (including refugees, persons having received temporary shelter, etc.) may also be admitted to primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational, higher education and research institutions on a general basis. The examination questions are translated during entrance examinations for those lacking knowledge of the Armenian language. In the rest of the cases, all the prescribed conditions of the competition apply to them equally, and in case of earning high points — they have the right to benefit from free of charge (stipend) seats.

Applicants having preferred to be admitted through the procedure for admission for foreign nationals may be admitted to the fee paid education system (first year) of primary vocational (handicraft), secondary vocational and higher education institutions, where they are fluent in the Armenian language and have minimum knowledge of the examination subjects. Foreign applicants having been admitted to state higher professional education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, with no knowledge of the Armenian language, are admitted to the preparatory faculty (departments) of higher education institutions for a one-year period, where they learn Armenian and study admission examination subjects.

According to the mentioned procedure, foreigners of Armenian origin or representatives of Armenian Diaspora may be allocated with 70 free of charge (stipend) seats where they have applied for the professions of Armenian studies, Pedagogy and Art.

Foreign citizens are provided with dormitories, if they wish.

2012, tuition fees of Syrian-Armenian students have been fully or partially — 70-75 % — refunded at the expense of resources of the Government of the Republic of Armenia, The Armenian General Benevolent Union and the Calouste Gulbenkian Foundation.

- Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

- ☒ Inclusion in mainstream education
- ☒ Provision of language courses
- ☐ Specific training for educational staff

- ☒ Initiatives addressing discrimination and promoting cultural diversity and mutual acceptance
- ☐ Alternative administrative procedure (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.)
- ☒ Accelerated learning programmes
- ☐ Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes
- ☐ Financial support
- ☐ Other innovative measures:

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Please briefly elaborate further on the measures taken:

Education in the Republic of Armenia is provided in accordance with the requirements of the Law of the Republic of Armenia “On language”: “The official language of the Republic of Armenia is Armenian which shall serve all spheres of life of the Republic. The language of teaching and upbringing in education and learning systems within the territory of the Republic of Armenia is literary Armenian.

Students are admitted to general education schools based on the Regulation “On enrolling children of school age into general education, organizing teaching and learning for the children enrolled in general education later than planned, and moving the students from one education institution to another and dismissing them”, as approved by Order No 06-N of the RA Minister of Education, Science, Culture and Sport, dated as of May 15, 2020. Pursuant to paragraph 6 of this Regulation, “foreign nationals, persons with no citizenship (legal representative thereof) (as well as in cases when one of the parents is a citizen of the Republic of Armenia, and the other one – any of the one mentioned herein) shall choose the language of instruction for their child independently. In the remaining cases, when the learner’s parents are citizens of the Republic of Armenia, the language of instruction is Armenian”.

Students are admitted to education institutions by way of order of the school principal, based on the application from the parent of the child of school-going age or the legal representative thereof and on the contract concluded between the institution and the parent, in accordance with the procedure established by the RA Law on General Education and the Charter of the education institution.

At the 3rd level of general education – high school –students may pursue further studies only upon availability of the basic school graduation certificate.

General education starts from age six, which may be full by the end of the given calendar year.

In case of availability of documents on taken study and compliance of the length of education levels, the grade of the student, who has discontinued his/her study abroad and returned to the Republic of Armenia, shall be determined based on the documents furnished.

The grade of the student, who has returned from abroad without relevant documents, shall be determined in accordance with the provisions specified in the Regulation.

The school principal shall admit the learner to corresponding grade, approve the

subject-specific individual study plans furnished by the teachers' subject-specific methodological units as per the curriculum, and the timetable of extra courses, whereby the learner's study will be organized to catch up.

Courses of Armenian language were organized for those who received asylum, refugee status in the Republic of Armenia, as well as for long-term migrants. In 2018 the Ministry organized the courses based on a memorandum of understanding with the AGBU Armenian Virtual university. The university committed to fund and organize free-of-charge training courses for 60 individuals. In 2018 Armenian language courses were taken by 25 refugees, and in 2019 0 by 10 refugees.

A new state program was initiated in the process of planning the 2019 State budget to organize Armenian language course for children of migrant families. Implementation will start from 2020-2021 school year.

Pursuant to Article 14 of the Law on "Making Amendments and Addenda to the Law on the Structure and Activities of the Government" of 16 May, 2019, the Ministries of Culture, Sports and Youth Affairs and Education and Science were merged into one- the Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sports. The Ministry of Diaspora has been reorganized into the Office of the Chief Commissioner for Diaspora Affairs, from now on operating in the Office of the Prime Minister of the Republic of Armenia.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments and to remove the obstacles encountered

1. Challenges and obstacles

1.1 Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country (several items could be ticked/mentioned):

☒ Challenges related to equitable access and inclusion in education (such as poverty and socio-economic factors, cultural and traditional attitudes, remoteness, migration and displacement, etc.)

- Social inequality at all levels entails challenges related to enrollment and drop-out,
- Due to social problems, a number of children from disadvantaged families (equally relevant for boys and girls) drop out of school in some stage of their studies, which is an obstruction for them to pursue vocational education, thereby increasing the risk of falling into poverty in the future. It is worth noting that boys mostly drop out because of work. This is more common in rural settlement,
- Due to early marriage, Yezidi girls do not get higher education after finishing school. Most often girls of this category marry off at 15 or 16 and even don't finish school,
- The enrolment indicator of learners in the third degree of general education is low,
- The enrolment of the poor, especially those in extreme poverty, higher professional education system is low,
- In terms of chances to get higher education, girls residing in rural areas are more vulnerable, which entails unequal treatment in the future,
- Higher education is not sufficiently accessible and available for persons in need of

special conditions for education,

- Children residing in rural communities do not have an opportunity to visit cultural centres (museum, theatre, cinema, concert hall, etc.) since such visits assume transportation costs which may become an additional financial burden for their families,
- Students and teachers have gender stereotypes, so it is necessary to enlarge the teaching of gender issues at all levels of education,
- The rights of the main participants of the education process i.e. students and teachers, are not sufficiently respected, and in this respect they are vulnerable,
- The human rights component is not sufficiently taught, it needs to be expanded starting from pre-school to include information about other nations and their cultures,
- There is insufficient awareness among parents about the role and importance of education.

- ✓ Challenges related to the quality of education (such as shortages of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff, non-supportive or inadequate teaching and learning as well as school environment, etc.)

- Transition from Western Armenian to Eastern Armenian creates difficulties for immigrant schoolchildren of Armenian national origin,
- Activities aimed at extracurricular/out-of-school upbringing of children are not effectively organised. The social condition of families impedes the effective organisation of leisure of children, particularly attendance thereby in interest groups in music, art, sports which are mainly arranged on paid basis,
- General education schools have limited capacities for providing education to children in need of special conditions for education; the teaching staff needs trainings on inclusive education,
- Educational and material resources and conditions of buildings of many educational institutions fail to comply with contemporary requirements. Building conditions of educational institutions are not accessible for persons with disabilities so they must be adapted,
- The network of hostel buildings is required to be improved in accordance with the format of urban-type European universities.

- ✓ Challenges relating to the system and governance (such as budgetary constraints, lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data, absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment, lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels, etc.)

- The pre-school institutions are not functioning in all communities, as a result the availability of pre-school educational services and the involvement of children in this field is low,
- The system of keeping on records the children having been dropped out of schools and that of involvement thereof in education, is incomplete,
- The data on the involvement of children in need of special conditions for education are not complete,

- A non-classified official statistics on the inclusion of national minorities in different educational levels is not collected,
- An official statistics on the cases of violence against children in general education schools and on reasons giving rise thereto, is not collected. For the purpose of giving an assessment to the mentioned phenomenon inquiries and surveys are sometimes carried out upon the initiative of separate organisations.

☐ Other:

1.2 Please provide a brief assessment of the effectiveness of the methods introduced to remove the obstacles encountered:

- The network of pre-school services is not sufficiently developed, which would have increased the accessibility of pre-school education.
- In Armenia, general education is available to everyone, for boys and girls, but the unequal involvement of students conditioned by gender and separate regions continues to be a challenge. In particular, in the 2018/2019 academic year, the gender equality index in the general secondary school was 1,04.
- The difference between the poor and the non-poor in the higher education is quite noticeable, which is a serious challenge in terms of overcoming poverty. In this regard, the issue of affordability of higher education continues to be problematic, which is due to the fact that after graduating from high school, the students of corresponding age from poor households are left out of the education system.
- Although Armenia has adopted a policy of inclusive general education, problems in adapting the physical environment, educational materials and teachers' abilities to the needs of students with special educational needs still exist.
- Distance learning at different levels of education is widely used in Armenia, but there is a need to improve the legislative framework and introduce new procedures in this area.
- Inter-sectoral cooperation is weak, which hinders the rapid and effective decision-making.

2. Awareness-raising

UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (several items could be ticked/mentioned)

- ☒ Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages
- ☒ Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education

- ☒ Increased public awareness through advocacy material on the Convention/ Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education
- ☐ Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments
- ☐ Other:

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Complété	Y
[id] Response ID	73
[startlanguage] Start language	en
[QG10Q1] Country name:	Republic of Armenia
[QG10Q2] Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report:	Deputy Minister of Education, Science, Culture and Sport of the Republic of Armenia
[QG11Q1] Is your country a State Party to the Convention?	Yes [Y]
[QG11(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)	
[QG11(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)	
[QG11(name)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)	
[QG11(size)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)	
Comptage des fichiers:	0
[QG12Q1] Has your country ratified the Protocol?	Yes [Y]
[QG12(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)	
[QG12(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)	
[QG12(name)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)	

[QG12(size)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)	
Comptage des fichiers:	0
[QG13Q1] Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law following its ratification?	Yes [Y]
[QG13Q3] Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked before and given effect to by courts, tribunals and administrative authorities?	No [A2]
[QG13Q3_comment] Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked before and given effect to by courts, tribunals and administrative authorities? (Comment)	
[QG13(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)	
[QG13(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)	
[QG13(name)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)	
[QG13(size)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)	
[QG13(title)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)	
[QG13(comment)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information	

regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)	
[QG13(name)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)	
[QG13(size)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)	
[QG13(title)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)	
[QG13(comment)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)	
[QG13(name)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)	
[QG13(size)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)	
Comptage des fichiers:	0
[QG2Q1_1] Please indicate measures adopted by your government to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1]: (Constitutional laws and/or legislation prohibit discrimination in education)	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q1_2] Please indicate measures adopted by your government to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education within the meaning of the	Yes [Y]

Convention/Recommendation [1]: (Regulations prohibit discrimination in education)	
[QG2Q1_3] Please indicate measures adopted by your government to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1]: (Policies and programmes aim to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education)	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q1_4] Please indicate measures adopted by your government to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1]: (Access to justice in case of violations of the right to non-discrimination in education)	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q1_5] Please indicate measures adopted by your government to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1]: (Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum)	
[QG2Q1_other] Please indicate measures adopted by your government to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1]: (Other)	
[QG2Q11] Please provide a brief description of the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts including measures on: Non-discrimination in the admission of pupils to educational institutions Non-differential treatment, including of foreign nationals resident in your country	The Republic of Armenia acceded, on 5 September 1993, to the UNESCO Convention against Discrimination in Education adopted on 14 December 1960. Since its independence the Republic of Armenia have been adopted laws (as well as other legal acts) targeted at ensuring equal access to education and excluding discrimination in education, regardless of cultural, economic, political and other conditions, as well as at assisting in ensuring equal opportunities for education. In particular: The first Constitution of the Republic of Armenia was adopted on 5 July 1995, in which fundamental rights and freedoms of persons and citizens are enshrined. For the purpose of implementing in recent years comprehensive reforms, amendments to the

	Constitution of the Republic of Armenia were adopted on 6 December 2015. The following provision on discrimination is enshrined in Article 29: "Discrimination based on sex, race, skin colour, ethnic or social origin, genetic features, language, religion, world view, political or other views, affiliation to a national minority, property status, birth, disability, age, or personal or social circumstances shall be prohibited."The right to education is enshrined in Article 38: "Everyone shall have the right to education.The programmes of compulsory education and the duration thereof shall be prescribed by law. Secondary education in state education institutions shall be free of charge. Everyone shall, in the cases and in the manner prescribed by law, have the right to free of charge education on a competitive basis in state higher and other vocational education institutions. Higher education institutions shall, to the extent prescribed by law, have the right to self-governance, including academic freedom and freedom of research". The Law of the Republic of Armenia (H.N.-0772-1-HO-52) "On language" was adopted on 17 April 1993, which prescribes the main provisions of the language policy of the Republic of Armenia, regulates the state of language, language relations of the bodies of state power and public administration, enterprises, institutions and organisations. The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-297)"On education" was adopted on 14 April 1999, which, based on the constitutional provisions, to a certain extent, guides the development of the education system. This Law stipulates state guarantees for the right to education, pursuant to which: "The Republic of Armenia shall ensure the right to education, regardless of the nationality, race, gender, language, belief, political or other views, social origin, property status or other circumstances."The legal equality of women and men has also been provided for in this Law. Following implementation of the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On education", a number of legal acts regulating separate fields of education have been adopted as well. In particular: For the purpose of implementing the state policy in the field of general education, ensuring the quality of and access to education, as well as improving the legislative framework of education, the Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-233-N) "On state inspectorate of education" was adopted on 15 November 2005, and the Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-160-N) "On general education" was adopted on 10 July 2009. The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-200-N) "On making supplements and amendments to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On general education'"was adopted on 1 December 2014, which provides for a transition from the system of general education to universal inclusive education. The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO 20 N) "On making amendments and supplements to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On education'"was also adopted on 8 April 2015, which prescribes the compulsory condition for a free of charge twelve-year (including vocational education) education. The Law shall enter into force from 1 January 2017. The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-164-N) "On primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education" was adopted on 8 July 2005. The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-62-N) "On higher and post-graduate professional education"was adopted on 14
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	December 2004. For the purpose of improving the legal framework for supplementary and continuing education, the Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-83-N) "On making supplements and amendments to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On education'" was adopted on 21 June 2014, which served as a basis for the approval of the Procedure for organising and implementing supplementary education programmes, prescribed by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1062-N of 10 September 2015, as well as the Procedure for evaluating and recognising the results of non-formal and informal instruction, prescribed by point 2 of the same Decision. The principles of the state policy of the Republic of Armenia at different levels of education, the legal and organisational, financial and economic grounds, the legal relations of natural and legal persons participating in the education process, the grounds for the right to education at different levels of education enshrined in the Constitution of the Republic of Armenia, etc., are regulated by the above-mentioned laws. The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-57-N) "On ensuring equal rights and equal opportunities for women and men" was also adopted on 20 May 2013. Following adoption of the mentioned laws, a number of legal acts have also been approved, supporting correct implementation of the laws.
[QG2Q2_1] Please indicate actions taken by your government to guarantee equal access to all levels and types of education in your country: (Constitutional laws and/or legislation guarantee equal access to education)	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q2_2] Please indicate actions taken by your government to guarantee equal access to all levels and types of education in your country: (Regulations ensure equal access to all levels and types of education)	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q2_3] Please indicate actions taken by your government to guarantee equal access to all levels and types of education in your country: (Policies and programmes ensure equal access to all levels and types of education)	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q2_other] Please indicate actions taken by your government to guarantee equal access to all levels and types of education in your country: (Other)	

[QG2Q21] Please indicate the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts and provide a brief description of the measures taken:

Education in the Republic of Armenia is provided in accordance with the requirements of the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On language": "The official language of the Republic of Armenia is Armenian which shall serve all spheres of life of the Republic. The language of teaching and upbringing in education and learning systems within the territory of the Republic of Armenia is literary Armenian. In the communities of national minorities of the Republic of Armenia general education instruction and upbringing may be organised in their native language in accordance with the state programme as well as with state support, by compulsory instruction of Armenian". Admission of a learner to a school of general education is carried out pursuant to Procedure for admission to, transfer from and removal of a learner from the institution of general education approved by Order of the Minister of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia No 1640-N of 24 November 2010. General education is provided starting from the age of six which may be attained by the end of the given calendar year. Admission of learners to an institution of general education is carried out on the basis of the application of the parent of a school-age child or the legal representative thereof or the contract concluded between the institution and the parent. The parent shall be responsible — as prescribed by law — for failure to ensure the right of the child to general education (or failure to enrol in school) before attaining the age of 16. At the 3rd level of general education – high school – students may pursue further studies only upon availability of the basic school graduation certificate. The admission to school of children of a citizen belonging to a national minority is carried out through instructing the child in his or her national (native) language or at school (classroom) providing a course in that language and in case of absence thereof the choice of the language of instruction is made by the parents of the children (learners). The choice of the language of instruction for children of foreign citizens, persons not having Armenian citizenship, those with dual citizenship, as well as where one of the parents is a citizen of the Republic of Armenia and the other is a foreigner is made by the parents of these children (their legal representative). Admission to state and accredited non-state institutions of handicraft and secondary vocational education shall be carried out according to the admission procedure approved by the Order of the Minister of Education and Science for the given academic year. For the purpose of sparking interest in secondary vocational education and increasing the enrolment of learners at this level, since 2011-2012 academic year admission has been carried out without admission examinations, except for professions pertaining to the fields of art, healthcare and sports. In this case, the competition-based admission (including primary vocational (handicraft)) is carried out on the basis of arithmetic mean of the grades in the graduation document and the total sum of the grades in the subjects considered to be competitive. Admission to a higher professional education institution is carried out pursuant to Procedure for admission to state and non-state higher education institutions (according to Bachelor's degree education programme) approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 597-N of 26

	April 2012. Admission to higher professional education institutions of the Republic of Armenia is also carried out on a competitive basis, based on admission examinations. Pursuant to the above-mentioned procedure, winners of International Olympiads in different subjects of general education instructed at a secondary school, medalists of World and European championships for different sports — having indicated the relevant professions in the admission application — are admitted to higher a education institution without admission examinations with the use of reserve seats allocated by the Government of the Republic of Armenia. Persons with secondary, primary vocational or secondary vocational education may be admitted to higher education institutions without age limit. Pursuant to the procedure, citizens of the Republic of Armenia with dual citizenship and foreigners may be admitted to higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia on general grounds or according to the procedure for admission of foreigners to education institutions. Admission to Master's degree and doctoral studies is carried out respectively in accordance with Procedure for admission to and instruction in Master's degree programme in higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia approved by Order of the Minister of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia No 1193-N of 6 December 2007 and Procedure for admission to and instruction within doctoral studies, as well as for registration for post-doctoral studies and external research approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 238-N of 25 February 2016. Thus, the process of admission of learners at different levels of education is regulated by legal acts approved for that purpose and discrimination is excluded. As regards the rights and obligations of the learners of different levels and other participants in the educational process, they are regulated by Laws of the Republic of Armenia "On general education", "On primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education" and "On higher and postgraduate professional education", as well as by the statutes of educational institutions. Thus, the noted legal acts regulate the relations established between the participants in the educational process, as well as non-discriminatory attitude.
[QG2Q3_1] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Providing financial incentives and fellowships)	Yes [Y]

[QG2Q3_2] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Providing positive or affirmative action measures)	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q3_3] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Ensuring inclusion in mainstream schools for all learners)	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q3_4] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Training teachers on inclusive education)	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q3_5] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and	

completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) and technical and vocational training (TVET))	
[QG2Q3_6] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Providing re-entry programmes for young mothers)	
[QG2Q3_7] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Eliminating all barriers for pregnant girls or young mothers in education)	
[QG2Q3_8] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion	Yes [Y]

of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Providing auxiliary assistance)	
[QG2Q3_9] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Adapting education infrastructure)	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q3_10] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Adapting curricula and methods)	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q3_11] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Providing language classes	Yes [Y]

to newcomers (e.g. refugees))	
[QG2Q3_12] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Eliminating administrative barriers to education [2])	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q3_13] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Providing flexible learning pathways)	
[QG2Q3_14] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Valuing diversity in schools)	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q3_15] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and	Yes [Y]

completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Combatting stereotyping and stigmatisation)	
[QG2Q3_other] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Other)	
[QG2Q31] Please elaborate further on the measures taken, including those to ensure gender equality and the empowerment of girls and women in and through education:	According to data of the Statistical Committee of the Republic of Armenia, almost entire population of Armenia is literate. According to the results of Census 2011, only 0.3% of the population is illiterate. The rate of literacy of people aged 15-24 comprises approximately 100%, and the ratio of the number of literate women to men aged 15-24 comprises 1. Thus, the literacy rate of adults and young people comprises approximately 99%, and there is no significant gender inequality in this regard. Concurrently, in 2018 the enrolment picture at different levels of education is as follows: gross enrolment ratio at school of general education comprised 83.0%; moreover at elementary school it comprised 91.1%, at basic school — 89.4%, at high school — 59.9%. The enrolment ratio of learners in the field of primary vocational (handicraft) education comprised 6.7% and in the field of secondary vocational education — 11.7%. Gross enrolment ratio of learners in the field of higher professional education comprised 38.3%. Gross enrolment ratio in the first level degree of higher professional education comprised 52.2%, whereas in the second level degree — 14.1%. Overall, in 2018 the enrollment in the vocational education system made 54.6% among the population subject to education. Conditioned by the requirements for successfully carrying out reforms in the field of education, "Prospective Development Strategic Programme of the Republic of Armenia for 2014-2025 " approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 442-N of 27 March 2014 envisaged consistent increase in state expenditures for education both in rated value and against the GDP ensuring the target of 3.7% against GDP by 2025. Nonetheless, the economic recession, decrease in GDP and narrowing of the scope of budget resources limited the possibilities for maintaining the

	expenditures in the envisaged amounts. The majority of state allocations targeted at the field of education — over 76.6%, was directed towards the financing of the field of general education in 2018 and 18.0% — towards the financing of professional education programmes. According to Prospective Development Strategic Programme of the Republic of Armenia for 2014-2025: "The field of education in Armenia is highlighted as one of the preconditions for sustainable progress of the country, reproduction and development of human capital, therefore, the development of this field is deemed to be one of the priorities for development of the country. Increasing education quality and effectiveness at all levels of the education system, bringing them in line with international standards, ensuring affordable/accessible education for all the strata of the population are priority objectives." For the purpose of ensuring equally accessible quality education and increasing the effectiveness of the field of education, reforms at all levels of education are being implemented in the country. Separate strategies and concepts also support those reforms. Moreover, all the processes implemented in the field of education are targeted at exercise of the right to education — equally for both women and men, without any discrimination — enshrined in the Constitution of the Republic of Armenia. General education is a priority in the sector of education as a basis for preparing children for independent life and further professional education. A range of initiatives have been implemented in the field of general education, in particular: a new mechanism for financing schools is applied (financing is carried out according to the number of pupils of the school); 12-year education system has been introduced, the process of publishing new textbooks and fully providing the learners with textbooks has been implemented. Textbook circulation system — ongoing mechanism for publishing textbooks — has been applied, which has led to reduction of expenses for obtaining textbooks, while the pupils of a more vulnerable group are provided with textbooks free of charge. Free of charge textbooks are also provided to pupils of 1st-4th years at the expense of state funds; courses ensuring comprehensive development of a person and applied qualities acquired by means of education have been introduced. For the purpose of developing robotics in schools of general education, robotics groups have been established in general education institutions of the Republic. As of January 2020, 575 engineering laboratories operate on the territory of Armenia. Around 15000 students get free engineering education. At Armath Engineering Laboratories kids aged 10-18 are introduced to science, technology, engineering, and math education through interactive after-school classes, exciting competitions, innovative camps and more; the subjects "Information Technologies", "Basics of Telecommunication" and "Microelectronics" were introduced in high schools. Introduction of the subject "National Songs and Dances" was a new step, which envisages preserving and passing on national values to generations, establishing a value system, instilling patriotism, preserving Armenian mindset. Introduction of the subject "Chess" was unprecedented, which sparked interest among the international educational community; unified examination
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	system for school graduation and admission to higher education institutions has been applied, as a result of which the process of transition of learners from school to higher education institutions has been facilitated; a network of high schools, operating separately and comprising 99 schools has been applied. High school (10th-12th years) is the main level ensuring pre-vocational education which greatly affects correct professional orientation and further learning success of learners. High schools have been provided with the required school property, computer devices, laboratories for physics, chemistry, biology, modern libraries equipped with literature; the application of modern information and communication technologies, as a new means for teaching and learning, has been expanded. Therefore, Internet access and equipment with computer devices in schools have been improved. "Armenian educational portal" (www.armedu.am, https://heravar.armedu.am/) has been developed, the content has been replenished and updated, on-line educational events have been organised (contests, Olympiads, conferences, discussions, surveys, photography and other creative competitions etc.); the system "Distance learning" has been applied (http://learning.armedu.am), by which distance courses of eight school subjects of the advanced stream of the 10th year (Armenian language, Russian language, Foreign language (English), Algebra, Physics, Chemistry, Biology, Armenian History) were organised for pupils of high school; the website "Database for Digital Resources" (http://lib.armedu.am) has been operated, where textbooks and training manuals, educational and methodical materials, subject related criteria and programmes have been posted; each year Republican Olympiads of 16 subjects of general education have been organised for schoolchildren, while Armenia has had team participation in International Olympiads of the subjects "Mathematics", "Physics", "Chemistry", "Information Science", "Astronomy" and "Biology"; In the system of primary and secondary vocational education: Procedure for granting student allowance and state stipend in state education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, implementing primary vocational (handicraft) and/or secondary vocational education programmes, was approved by Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No1330-N of 28 November 2013. In order to increase the involvement of learners also at this level of education, since 2011-2012 academic year, admission has been carried out without admission examinations, except for professions pertaining to the fields of art, healthcare and sports; steps have been taken to ensure involvement of children — in need of special conditions for education — of vulnerable groups in the system of primary and secondary vocational education, facility conditions of some institutions have been adapted for persons with disabilities. Increased funding for financing the provision of education for children in need of special conditions for education and state non-commercial organisations of the Republic of Armenia implementing primary vocational (handicraft) education has been established and introduced according to point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 884-N of 15 July 2010. In the system of
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	higher and postgraduate professional education: Procedure for granting student allowance and state stipend in higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, which was approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1183-N of 27 July 2006, has been implemented since 2006. Competitive education and the idea of student rotation according to academic performance play an essential role within the general context of the mentioned reforms. Pursuant to the requirements of the mentioned Procedure, the state shall continue to refund the tuition fees of socially disadvantaged students in the amount of 50-100%; the expansion of joint programmes implemented by higher education institutions through contracts signed between higher education institutions, based on common educational standards, is underway. With the support of the EU, student exchange and joint education programmes, as well as review of education programmes according to educational outcomes are being carried out at higher education institutions; Procedure for distance learning of professions of higher and post-graduate professional education has been introduced since 2010, which will enable to make the application of e-environment, innovative technologies in the fields of education and science more systematic and ensure additional educational opportunities for citizens; Pursuant to the Procedure for granting student allowance and state stipend in higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, the State has implemented refund of tuition fees for socially disadvantaged students in the amount of 50-100 %. In 2015, the procedure for reviewing the mechanisms aimed at refund of tuition fees for students of socially vulnerable groups was implemented, the circle of socially disadvantaged students was expanded — including also first year students. Tumo Center for Creative Technologies is run in Armenia which was founded in Armenia and then became a brand for export. Currently 3 such centers function in Armenia and two more are planned to be launched in 2020. With Tumo Armenia became a country of innovative laboratory of ideas which has already started exporting it to the countries such as France, Lebanon, Artsakh and Germany, and to Albania in new future. Students of 12-28 age group attend the centers in Armenia for 14 various educational programs including graphic design, programming and robotics. The programs are available equally for boys and girls. On 20 May 2013, the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On ensuring equal rights and equal opportunities for women and men" (HO-57-N) was adopted, which prescribes the guarantees for ensuring equal rights and equal opportunities of women and men in political, social, economic, cultural, as well as other fields of public life, and regulates the relations arising with regard thereto. The purpose of this Law is to ensure equality of women and men in all fields of public life - including the sectors of education and culture, legal protection of women and men against possible discrimination, support for formation of civil society, and the establishment of democratic relations in the society. In order to promote legal equality between women and men and prevent discrimination, public administration bodies of the Republic of Armenia, along with several international organisations, such as
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	OSCE Yerevan Office (until 2017), UN Population Fund, etc., implement various programmes, which assist the authorities and the civil society in improving the legislation. At the same time, works are being implemented with the media to improve the coverage of existing problems and to break the stereotypes. Data on the involvement of both men and women at different levels of education are presented in the following subpoints. The admission of foreign nationals (including representatives of the Armenian Diaspora) to vocational education institutions of the Republic of Armenia is regulated by international treaties of the Republic of Armenia on co-operation in the sectors of education and science concluded between the Republic of Armenia and other states, as well as in accordance with the Procedure for admission of foreign nationals, as well as members of families of diplomats working in the diplomatic service bodies of the Republic of Armenia, operating in a foreign state, to higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 700-N of 28 April 2011, the Procedure for admission to primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1295-N of 25 August 2011. The purpose of the existence of separate procedures for admission is to: make education at educational institutions of the Republic of Armenia accessible for foreign nationals; contribute to upbringing with the spirit of respect towards nations and mutual understanding, help spark interest among the youth in Armenian cultural heritage and contribute to the development of Armenian studies. Foreign nationals having received secondary education in the Republic of Armenia and residing in Armenia (including refugees, asylum seeker, etc.) may also be admitted to primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational, higher education and research institutions on a general basis. The examination questions are translated during entrance examinations for those lacking knowledge of the Armenian language. In the rest of the cases, all the prescribed conditions of the competition apply to them equally, and in case of earning high points — they have the right to benefit from free of charge (stipend) seats. Applicants having preferred to be admitted through the procedure for admission for foreign nationals may be admitted to the fee paid education system (first year) of primary vocational (handicraft), secondary vocational and higher education institutions, where they are fluent in the Armenian language and have minimum knowledge of the examination subjects. Foreign applicants having been admitted to state higher professional education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, with no knowledge of the Armenian language, are admitted to the preparatory faculty (departments) of higher education institutions for a one-year period, where they learn Armenian and study admission examination subjects. According to the mentioned procedure, foreigners of Armenian origin or representatives of Armenian Diaspora may be allocated with 70 free of charge (stipend) seats where they have applied for the professions of Armenian studies, Pedagogy and Art. Foreign citizens are provided with dormitories, if they wish. Since 2012,
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	tuition fees of Syrian-Armenian students have been fully or partially — 70-75 % — refunded at the expense of resources of the Government of the Republic of Armenia, The Armenian General Benevolent Union and the Calouste Gulbenkian Foundation. Steps have been taken to introduce the universal inclusive education system, in particular: On 1 December 2014, the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On making amendments to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On general education'" (HO 200 N) was adopted, which provides that the universal inclusive education system shall be introduced in the Republic of Armenia until 1 August 2025. For the purpose of ensuring implementation of the Law, "Action plan and the timetable of the universal inclusive education system introduction activities" have been approved by point 1 of Protocol Decision No 6-12 of the Government of the Republic of Armenia of 18 February 2016. According to the Action Plan and the Timetable, a number of special institutions of general education of the Republic will be reorganised into pedagogical and psychological support centres. As a result of implementation of the system, children in need of special conditions for education will receive a pedagogical and psychological support service at 3 levels: in the school of general education, in the territorial and republican pedagogical and psychological support centres. A new form of funding will be introduced in schools of general education and a vacancy for a teaching assistant will be made available. The introduction of the system will be carried out step by step, starting from regions and gradually covering the whole territory of the Republic. The process started in 2016. The universal inclusive education system has been introduced in 7 regions of RA. The US Agency for International Development, the Office of the United Nations Children's Fund in Armenia, "World Vision Armenia" International Development and Charitable Organisation, "Bridge of Hope" NGO assist in the implementation of the Programme. The newly-established system will allow to organise the education and upbringing of children in need of special conditions for education without separating children from their families, ensuring their comprehensive social development and enrolling them in an institution of general education. Through the policy pursued in the field, it is envisaged to promote the opportunities of receiving quality education for children in need of special conditions for education by introducing an inclusive education system in all schools of general education. As a result of the transition to a universal inclusive education system, the number of special schools is decreasing year by year. Currently, there are 10 special schools in Armenia, instead of the previous 23. The "Sun" talking computer programme functions in special school No 14 for visually impaired children in Yerevan; the school is equipped with over 6 textbooks printed in Braille, as well as 2000 workbooks. A special class for sign language instruction is organised at Yerevan Special Educational Complex for Children with Hearing Impairments, which is the only institution in the Republic to organise education for deaf children. The Bilingual Method is applied at the school; teaching is carried out by two methods: sign language and mother tongue. Pursuant to point 105 of the Procedure for admission to state and non-state higher education institutions (according to
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	the educational programme for the Bachelor's degree) approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 597-N of 26 April 2012, citizens disabled while performing their duties during compulsory military service, in case of successfully passing the examinations, shall be admitted on an out-of-competition basis, at the expense of the funds of the State Budget of the Republic of Armenia. Besides, pursuant to point 106 of the mentioned Procedure, persons of the first or second groups of disability and children with disabilities under the age of 18 who have scored enough points to get admitted under the fee paid system, shall be admitted to free of charge system at the expense of the funds of the State Budget of the Republic of Armenia. The mentioned procedures are of a continuous nature, and in order to receive funding, a higher education institution must submit an application to the Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sport of the Republic of Armenia. Furthermore, measures are being implemented to adapt the buildings of educational institutions to the needs of persons with disabilities. The 5th and 9th blocks of the National Polytechnic University of Armenia have been adapted to the needs of persons with disabilities. A programme converting the existing literature into audio books was installed in one of the computers in the reading hall of the Armenian State Pedagogical University after Kh.Abovyan for visually challenged visitors. The lecture halls on the first floors of the blocks of Yerevan Brusov State University of Languages and Social Sciences, of the Armenian State Institute of Physical Culture and Sport are adapted to the needs of persons with movement disorders, therefore classes for students with movement disorders are conducted on the first floor. Since 2014, "Unison" NGO has been implementing a programme aimed at introducing an inclusivity policy in higher education institutions. The inclusivity standards of higher education institutions are developed. All the stakeholders, including the representatives of higher education institutions have been involved in the process of policy development. Besides, the buildings of educational institutions, namely kindergartens, schools of general education and colleges have been adapted to the needs of persons with disabilities (construction of wheelchair ramps, renovation of sanitary facilities, installation of platform lifts) at the expense of the funds allocated from the 2017-2019 State Budget. The School Meals Programme has been introduced, and relevant funds have been allocated from the State Budget of the Republic of Armenia for implementation of the Programme since 2014. Meanwhile, the School Meals Programme under the United Nations World Food (UN WFP) Programme is still underway. The Government of the Republic of Armenia has undertaken the commitment of ensuring the continuity of the School Meals Programme, and to this end, the strategy and the implementation plan of the Sustainable School Meals Programme was approved by point 1 of Protocol Decision No 52-37 of the sitting of the Government of the Republic of Armenia of 27 December 2012. And in 2014-2019, the Sustainable School Meals Programme was introduced in 6 regions of the Republic. Within the framework of the Programme, children in primary classes of state schools of general education as well as children enrolled in pre-school
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	preparation groups (pre-school education institutions) in the mentioned 6 marzes receive free of charge meals. In other regions, school meals are provided by the UN WFP. The Programme is aimed at increasing the enrolment in primary classes, as well as fostering healthy lifestyle among learners. It is envisaged to gradually increase the number of marzes included in the Programme, thus increasing the number of children receiving school meals.
[QG2Q32] Please indicate whether your country has adopted and reviewed legislation related to the minimum age for marriage so that it conforms to international standards (18 years):	Yes [Y]
[QG2Q33] Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions:	The minimum age of marriage for women and men was set at eighteen by the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On making amendments to the Family Code of the Republic of Armenia" (HO-26) of 20 May 2013.
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Comptage des fichiers:	0
[QG21Q1_SQ001] Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available in your country? (Pre-primary education is compulsory: Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:)	
[QG21Q1_SQ001comment] Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available in your country? (Comment)	
[QG21Q1_SQ002] Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available in your country? (Pre-primary education is free of charge for all: Please provide the duration:)	
[QG21Q1_SQ002comment] Is compulsory and free of	

charge pre-primary education available in your country? (Comment)	
[QG21Q2] Please list the laws and policies that ensure the availability of pre-primary education for all and provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government in the realization of access to pre-primary education. Brief quantitative information could be added.	Pre-school education is regulated by the Constitution, the laws on Education, General Education, Local Administration, Child Rights, State Non-Profit Organisations, by Labour and Family Codes, by the Republic of Armenia international agreements, other laws and legal acts. In Armenia preschool education is not mandatory. The preschool age is 0-6-year-old. Preschool Institutions (PSI) are administered by communities. Not all the communities have operating PSIs, therefore child access level to pre-school is low. In particular, according to the data for 2018, child access to PSIs (within 0-5 age population) was 32.6% out of which 38.0% in urban and 22.6% in rural settlements. Gross participation of 3-5-year-old children in preschool in 2018 was 58.4% (56.5% boys and 60.5% girls) With the aim to support the sector and ensure accessibility of preschool educational services, resources are allocated for piloting cost-effective models. With the financial support of World Bank, a new credit program titled Education Improvement is being implemented which supports continuous efforts towards establishing cost-effective pre-school service microprojects to raise the level of children's readiness for school and to ensure equal starting opportunities in education. Within this project in 2016-2019 82 institutions implementing pre-school programs were sponsored with the result of 2030 more children being engaged in preschool education. It's planned to establish 20 more preschool institutions in 2020. To ensure sustainability of preschool programs that function as a part of secondary primary school, allocations are made from the RA state budget due to estimations calculated by formula for an annual spending per child in primary level. In 2019 the budget allocations mentioned above were directed for organising preschool education of 7000 children. In Yerevan the community-based kindergartens are free of charge due to the community budget allocations. Kindergartens in regions may have charges depends on the decision of community governing bodies Following the requirements of Education 2030: Incheon Declaration and Framework for Action Towards inclusive and equitable quality education and lifelong learning for all and Education for All Declaration, on May 6, 2020, the National Assembly of Armenia has adopted the RA Law on Amendments to the Law on Preschool Education which includes the following activity framework: - Diversify the types of organising preschool education - Expansion of preschool services with special attention to rural and bordering settlements, - Establish alternative cost effective models - Set conditions for inclusion of children in need of special educational conditions. In particular, the first part of Article 4 of the Law states that the Republic of Armenia declares and ensures inclusivity, accessibility and quality of preschool education as an important guarantee for securing each child's right to education, development and upbringing, secure environment, maintaining and strengthening life and health. The law also guarantees accessibility and availability of pre-school education for all children from urban

	and rural areas through universally inclusive education, including children with disabilities, socially and economically vulnerable children. Particularly, it is expected to maintain universal inclusion and accessibility of preschool education: accessibility of inclusive and quality preschool education for all children of 3-6 age including children in need of special educational conditions, and maximum engagement of children at age 5.
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Comptage des fichiers:	0
[QG22Q1] Is primary education compulsory in your country?	Yes [Y]
[QG22Q11] Please indicate the current duration period of compulsory education and the age of enrolment:	Pursuant to the laws of the Republic of Armenia "On education" and "On general education", elementary education, being the first degree of secondary education, is free of charge and compulsory. Until 2015, the basic general education was compulsory, but on 8 April 2015 amendments were made to the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On general education", by virtue of which part 4 of Article 4 of the Law was amended to read as follows: "4. Secondary education shall be compulsory, except for the cases prescribed by law. 5. Secondary education shall be free of charge at state education institutions. 6. A 12-year secondary education shall be provided in the Republic of Armenia". The provision of the law, which stipulates the requirement of compulsory secondary education, entered into force on 1 June, 2017, before which basic education will be considered mandatory. Pursuant to the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On general education", the basic programmes of general education shall be formed according to the principles of succession and continuity. They shall be classified as follows: the 1st degree — elementary/primary (4 years); the 2nd degree — basic (9 years) ; the 3rd degree — secondary (12 years). Thus, the 2nd degree of general education, i.e. basic education, comprises also elementary education. Admission to the first grade of school is open for those children who have reached the age of six or are due on December 31 of the given calendar year. The highest enrolment of learners is at the level of elementary education — 91,1%. The rate for the indicator of students' gender equality at the level of primary education was 1.01. In the academic year of 2018-2019, 98-80% of students

	positively passed the final exams at the primary school. In 2018, the share of children finishing the primary school, who obtained at least the minimum level of knowledge from reading and mathematics, was 88.24% (boys: 88.27%, girls: 88.19%). According to the UNESCO Institute for Statistics, the participation rate in organized learning (by sex), one year before the official primary entry age made 47.5% in 2018 (boys 45.8%, girls 49.5%). This indicator is, in fact, important, and reflects the enrollment of children in programs preparing them for school. The higher this figure, the smoother the transition of students from kindergarten to school. This may be explained by the fact that literacy of learners develops mainly in elementary schools. Pursuant to the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On education" (HO-297-N), the requirement for the basic general education to be compulsory remains for learners under the age of 16 and the twelve-year secondary education may be realised before the learner attains the age of 19, if this right has not been exercised earlier.
[QG22Q2] Is primary education available free of charge to all?	Yes [Y]
[QG22Q21] Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is.	Secondary education is free of charge in all educational institutions of the Republic of Armenia offering general education programmes. Secondary education includes primary and secondary education. At the same time, in the academic year of 2018-2019, 98.76% of students passed their final exams at the level of basic education, and 99.38% at the level of high schools. At the expense of the state budget the state provides to primary school students with textbooks designed for basic general education programs. There is no mandated school uniform, so it is the parents who buy it. The transportation expenses of the students from rural regional settlements of RA (for whom the nearest school is located in an area more than 5 km away from their place of residence) are reimbursed at the expense of the RA state budget. In this tier of schooling there are no mandatory fees for students attending RA public schools.
[QG22Q3] Is secondary education (middle/high) available free of charge?	Yes [Y]
[QG22Q31] Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is:	Pursuant to the laws of the Republic of Armenia "On education" and "On general education" the 12-year secondary education in state educational institutions is free of charge. However, families incur additional educational expenses for the education of their children which include the purchase of textbooks, school supplies and transport expenses but generally, this is not a major problem for families at the levels of elementary and secondary education. However, these additional educational expenses are a heavy burden for poor families and especially for those having children studying at higher grades. Besides, in order to enter a higher education institution after completing high school, most of the learners often take private classes/lessons which also require expenses from the families. Thus, according to the learners, the two main reasons/arguments for failing to continue studies in high school after graduating from basic school are the completion of the

	basic education and the social standing of the family (or high tuition fees). From the RA state budget funds areas provided for the reimbursement of the rent of textbooks for children from socially vulnerable families and 38 bordering communities, as well as for the transportation expenses of students from rural settlements in the regions of the Republic of Armenia (for whom the nearest school is located in an area more than 5 km away from their place of residence).
[QG22Q4] Is secondary education (middle/high) compulsory in your country?	Yes [Y]
[QG22Q41] Please provide details on its implementation and indicate the duration of compulsory secondary education and the age of enrolment:	Secondary education lasts 12 years. Children are admitted to school from the age of 6. Concurrently, in 2018 the enrolment picture at different levels of education is as follows: gross enrolment ratio at school of general education comprised 83.0%; moreover at elementary school it comprised 91.1%, at basic school —89.4%, at high school — 59.9%. The rate for the students' gender equality in secondary education was 1.04, specifically at the level of primary education (grades 1-4) it was 1.01, at the level of basic education (grades 1-9) it was 1.01, and on the level of high schools (grades 10-12) it was 1.20. As it has already been mentioned, the highest enrolment of pupils is at the level of elementary education — 91.1%. The enrolment in the system of basic education has slightly decreased comprising 89.4% and is homogeneous in terms of territory, gender and poverty groups and there have been no significant disparities in this regard. The gross enrolment rate at high schools is relatively low, comprising 59.9%. After graduating from basic school, the majority of the population of the appropriate age continued their education in primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education institutions. The secondary education is compulsory for all, except for cases prescribed by law, and probably this is the reason why the enrolment rate in basic schools is high. Thus, in general, it can be noted that all groups of the population have access to basic education and there have been no significant disparities in this regard. Therefore, enrolment of almost all children in basic schools is guaranteed in Armenia. The following actions will be taken to make general education universally available: • The universal inclusive education system will be expanded and introduced in all regions of Armenia, and • Transportation costs for students from rural areas (for whom the nearest school is located in an area more than 5 km away from their place of residence) will continue to be reimbursed. • provision of free of charge textbooks and study materials to the pupils of elementary grades as well as to the socially disadvantaged children will continue; • the scopes of School Meals Programme will be expanded by involving larger number of pupils from elementary schools, etc. Simultaneously, cooperation with a number of international organisations implementing programmes aimed at social protection of learners, will continue. In the field of Primary vocational (handicraft) education- Instruction has been carried out on the basis of basic and secondary education. The gross enrolment ratio of students has made up 6.7% (3.9% of women and 9.2% of men), the

	Gender Equality Index — 0.42. In the field of Secondary vocational education- Instruction has been carried out on the basis of basic and secondary education. The gross enrolment ratio of students has made up 11.7% (13.1% of women and 10.7% of men), the Gender Equality Index — 1.26. Since 2012-2013 academic year, the number of seats in free of charge instruction system (full refund of tuition fees in the form of allowance) of educational institutions implementing primary (handicraft) and secondary vocational education programmes has generally increased by 50%. At the same time, before 2011, admission to state and accredited non-state secondary vocational institutions was carried out on a competitive basis through admission examinations. With the aim to enhance attractiveness of secondary vocational education and enrolment of learners at this level of education, since 2011-2012 academic year admission has been carried out without admission examinations, except for the professions pertaining to the fields of art, healthcare and sports, in case whereof professional examination shall be taken. The competition-based admission (including primary vocational (handicraft)) is carried out on the basis of the arithmetical average of the grades in the graduation document and the total sum of the grades in the subjects considered to be competitive for the given profession. As a result of the above mentioned activities, enrolment at primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education level has generally increased in the recent years. This implies that certain proportion of pupils of high schools and graduates of secondary school have preferred to continue their education at the vocational education level, which proves the efficiency of the implemented policy. Besides, at this level of primary vocational education, the number of boys prevails, whereas at the secondary vocational education level there are no substantial gender differences. At the same time, efforts aimed at ensuring continuity of the learners' education and revising the content of education, modernising professions, encouraging learners and other activities have continued to be made at this level of vocational education. In particular: procedure for admission and secondment of citizens of bordering or high mountainous settlements to education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, carrying out primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education programmes, as well as the list of professions establishing certain privileges for citizens of bordering or high mountainous settlements were approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 651-N of 12 June 2014; the process of transition from secondary vocational education institutions to higher education institutions has been facilitated. Pursuant to the Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-17-N) "On making amendments and a supplement to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On education'" adopted on 5 June 2014, graduates of secondary vocational education institutions, having shown high academic performance, may continue their education in higher education institutions under relevant profession – in the second year – through distance learning; the lists of vocational education and training professions have been revised by bringing them in line
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	with the requirements of labour market, National framework of qualifications (NFQ) and UNESCO classification of occupations.
[QG22Q42] Indicate whether your country has adopted and reviewed legislation related to the minimum age of entry into employment so that it is aligned with the end of compulsory education:	Yes [Y]
[QG22Q43] Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions:	According to Article 17, Part 2, Clause 2.2 of the RA Labor Code, «Persons under the age of fourteen may be engaged in creation of works (creative work) and/or performance thereof in cinematographic, sports, theatrical and concert organisations, circuses, television and radio companies upon written consent of one of the parents/guardian/adopter or of the guardianship and custody body which must not cause harm to their health and morals, as well as must not interfere with their education or safety. Persons between the ages of fourteen and eighteen may not be engaged in work on weekends, non-working days — holidays and memorial days — except when participating in sporting and cultural events. A temporary employment contract shall be concluded with persons under the age of 16». The mentioned provisions of the Code have remained unchanged.
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[QG23Q1_1] Please indicate the measures adopted to	Yes [Y]

ensure that there is no discrimination on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation[1] to enter and complete higher education, including technical and vocational education and training: (Constitutional laws and/or legislation prohibit discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training)	
[QG23Q1_2] Please indicate the measures adopted to ensure that there is no discrimination on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation[1] to enter and complete higher education, including technical and vocational education and training: (Regulations prohibit discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training)	Yes [Y]
[QG23Q1_3] Please indicate the measures adopted to ensure that there is no discrimination on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation[1] to enter and complete higher education, including technical and vocational education and training: (Policies and programs aim to eliminate and prevent discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training)	
[QG23Q1_other] Please indicate the measures adopted to ensure that there is no discrimination on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation[1] to enter and complete higher education, including technical and vocational	

education and training: (Other)	
[QG23Q11] Please provide a brief description of the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts including measures on: Non-discrimination in the admission of students to higher education institutions on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation Non-differential treatment, including of foreign students	Amendments to the Constitution of the Republic of Armenia were adopted on 6 December 2015. The following provision on discrimination is enshrined in Article 29: "Discrimination based on sex, race, skin colour, ethnic or social origin, genetic features, language, religion, world view, political or other views, affiliation to a national minority, property status, birth, disability, age, or personal or social circumstances shall be prohibited."The right to education is enshrined in Article 38: "Everyone shall have the right to education.The programmes of compulsory education and the duration thereof shall be prescribed by law. Secondary education in state education institutions shall be free of charge. Everyone shall, in the cases and in the manner prescribed by law, have the right to free of charge education on a competitive basis in state higher and other vocational education institutions. Higher education institutions shall, to the extent prescribed by law, have the right to self-governance, including academic freedom and freedom of research". The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-297)"On education" was adopted on 14 April 1999, which, based on the constitutional provisions, to a certain extent, guides the development of the education system. This Law stipulates state guarantees for the right to education, pursuant to which: "The Republic of Armenia shall ensure the right to education, regardless of the nationality, race, gender, language, belief, political or other views, social origin, property status or other circumstances."The legal equality of women and men has also been provided for in this Law.
[QG23Q2_1] Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge: (Higher education is generally free of charge)	
[QG23Q2_2] Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge: (Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)	Yes [Y]
[QG23Q2_3] Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally	Yes [Y]

accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge: (Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships)	
[QG23Q2_4] Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge: (Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures)	Yes [Y]
[QG23Q2_5] Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge: (Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states)	Yes [Y]
[QG23Q2_other] Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge: (Other)	
[QG23Q21] Please elaborate on the measures taken and provide brief information on the financial costs to receive education in higher public or private education institutions, if higher education is not free of charge:	Gross enrolment ratio in the first level degree of higher professional education comprised 52.2% (56.6% of women and 48.2% of men), the Gender Equality Index — 1.17. The gross enrolment ratio in the second level degree of higher professional education comprised 14.1 % (19.4% of women and 8.9% of men), the Gender Equality Index— 14.1. In recent years, the enrollment of students in these two levels of higher education has increased. However, the number of PhD students has comparatively decreased. In 2018 it was 985 people, 57.5% of whom were female. The higher professional education in Armenia is provided in state and non-state higher professional education institutions (including accredited) on a free of charge and fee paid basis. Legislation on higher education of the Republic of Armenia is mainly regulated by the Laws of the Republic of Armenia "On education" and "On higher and postgraduate professional education" as well as secondary legislative acts deriving therefrom. Law and separate regulations prescribe the minimum requirements for admission to all the three levels of higher education institution, unified graduation

	and admission examinations according to the professions and universities. For certain socially vulnerable groups — taking also into consideration the academic performance of a student — admission and education in higher education institutions are organised under privileged conditions to ensure access to higher education for all the citizens. This is regulated by the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On higher and postgraduate professional education" and the Procedure for granting student allowances and state stipends in higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, as well as internal regulations of higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, which must not contradict to the norms prescribed by law. Pursuant to Article 6 of the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On higher and postgraduate professional education": "The higher education institution shall, at its own expense and in the amount of at least seven per cent of the budget generated from the tuition fees of students, taking as a basis the high academic performance and the social group, partially refund, in the form of student allowances, the tuition fees of at least ten per cent of the students studying in fee paid instruction system – for the students holding the following status: (1) socially disadvantaged students (those from families falling under the grade with one point higher than the marginal grade of socially disadvantaged condition of families) — in the amount of at least 30 per cent; (2) students left without parental care after attaining the age of 18 — until they attain the age of 23 — in the amount of at least 50 per cent; (3) students having been deprived of one parent (having one parent) and having not attained the age of 23 — in the amount of at least 50 per cent; (4) students having a child under the age of 1 — in the amount of at least 50 per cent; (5) students from families with three and more minors or three and more students — in the amount of at least 30 per cent; (6) students having a disabled parent of 1st or 2nd group, including a disabled parent considered as a freedom fighter — in the amount of at least 30 per cent; (7) students having passed compulsory fixed-term military service and engaged in combat duty at military units carrying out combat duty — at least 30 per cent; (8) socially disadvantaged students (from families falling under any grade higher than the grade of 0 kept on records in the evaluation system of socially disadvantaged condition of families) — at least 20 per cent; (9) students holding other status, which may be defined by the higher education institution". Rotation evaluation system is being implemented in the higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, which enables the students, having shown the best academic performance in the year, to study on a free of charge basis. Free of charge seats are also provided to the student studying in target spheres. On April 23, 2020 (entered into force on September 1, 2020) amendments were made to the RA Government Decision N 1403-N of November 29, 2007, as a result of which the amount of scholarships given to PhD students was increased by 35,000 AMD, making 65.000 AMD for Armenian studies students, 60.000 AMD for Science students, 55.000 AMD for Economics and Law students, as well as 65.000 AMD for Doctoral students. As a social support, based on the regulations for granting student allowances and state
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	scholarships in universities, the state reimbursed 50-100% of tuition fees of about 2230 socially vulnerable students, and for 917 students from families living in border or remotemountainousareas. Number of students who received reimbursement in 2019 was 3147. Amount of money id 654 million AMD, 525 million of which was paid to socially vulnerable students. According to the Government Decision N 1464 of December 13, 2019 tuition fees of 25 full-time Undergraduate students in State Universities with two or more children were fully reimbursed. The process of providing nominal scholarships to students with the best academic achievement in universities has continued. According to the decree of the Minister of Education, Science, Culture and Sports, 38 winner students from 7fields (Natural sciences (including Mathematical-information-communication technologies (ICT)), Medicine, Humanities, Social Sciences, Engineering (including Architectural/Agricultural), Culture-sports, Armenian Studies were awarded annual nominal scholarships. In addition to the above mentioned, the citizens of the Republic of Armenia — for the purpose of studying in the higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia — are also supported by the Youth Foundation of Armenia, as well as a number of other foundations financing education of the students of Armenian nationality (including Armenian General Benevolent Union, Hrayr and Anna Hovnanian Foundation). Credit funds, provided through state subsidies by the commercial banks and credit organisations of the Republic of Armenia, are also available as a financial support with an interest rate of 12-15%, 2-3% out of which is subsidised by the state according to the academic performance of the student, and are provided upon the recommendation letter of parents/guardians and for the purpose of studying in state and non-state higher education institutions. Pursuant to the Procedure for admission of foreign nationals, as well as members of families of diplomats working in the diplomatic service bodies of the Republic of Armenia, operating in a foreign state, to higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 700-N of 28 April 2011, making education in the higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia accessible for foreigners and organising for them instruction either in literary Armenian or foreign languages is guaranteed. Pursuant to the mentioned procedure, admission of the foreign nationals to the higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia is not carried out on a competitive basis; the number of fee paid seats is not limited either. Performed knowledge checks are only aimed to assess proficiency in the Armenian language and other subjects defined for admission in order to direct the applicant either to the first year or to the preparation course. No cases of obvious inequality between women's and men's rights, substantially considered as a possible violation of law, have been recorded so far. Issues related to students' accommodation, health and rest conditions are also important. With regard to the students from regions studying in the higher education institutions of the capital, the state provides state grants to 200 students in total, as a result the students are able to solve the problem of accommodation
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	with little rental fee. At the same time, students are provided with dormitories at discounted prices. However, this is not enough to meet the students' demand for accommodation. Therefore, in order to solve the accommodation problem, students have to rent apartments which are rather expensive even in the suburbs of the capital (the average price for renting an apartment is AMD 107. 000). There are first aid rooms necessarily functioning in all higher education institutions for the purpose of providing first aid to students. Besides, there is a student medical clinic in Yerevan which renders a relevant service to the students of a given higher education institution within the framework of contracts signed with the higher education institutions. Most of the state higher education institutions have, under their subordination, operating institutions for organising leisure, where the students of the given higher education institution may spend their holidays at a low price. Moreover, higher education institutions also provide free of charge holiday tickets to socially disadvantaged students having shown high academic performance. As a result of the above mentioned activities, enrolment at the highest professional education level has generally increased in the recent years. This is to state that the reforms made in the field of higher education resulted in the increase of targeting. In spite of the above mentioned regulations, the higher education system in the Republic of Armenia still faces a problem with increasing access, which is mainly conditioned by insufficient financial resources. To solve this problem, it is envisaged to increase the portion for higher education in the Gross Domestic Product of the Republic of Armenia, introduce a mechanism for financing — based on performance — of state higher education institutions, increase allocations for providing funding for the costs of education of students, diversify the sources and instruments of financing, improve conditions in dormitory, create new dormitory complexes and promote instruction in a foreign language, ensure affordability and accessibility of higher education for different social groups and for persons in need of special conditions for education. At the same time, steps have been taken to increase the number and amount of scholarships of Armenian citizens sent to foreign universities and foreign students studying in Armenian universities within the framework of interstate agreements. As of January 2020, within the framework of the Erasmus+ program 74 Armenian students are studying in 17 countries. Within the framework of interstate agreements, 101 places have been allocated for higher and postgraduate education in Armenia for students from 12 countries of the world, and 109 places for studying in those countries from Armenia. Within the framework of interstate agreements, the University faculty has opportunity to participate in training programs. Considering that Distance learning is now spreading not only in Armenia but all over the world as a form of non-formal education, steps are being taken to make e-learning available throughout Armenia. At present, the courses organized by educational institutions with different means of telecommunication and in different educational platforms, the preparation and broadcasting of TV programmes, the
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	implementation of lectures, lesson preparations and other teaching processes using computer and mobile applications have become applicable in Armenia.
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[QG24Q1_1] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education)	
[QG24Q1_2] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Provision of literacy programmes)	

[QG24Q1_3] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Provision of appropriate learning and life-skills programmes)	
[QG24Q1_4] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Provision of free of charge learning opportunities)	
[QG24Q1_5] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Provision of flexible learning pathways)	Yes [Y]
[QG24Q1_6] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Provision of professional training and qualifications)	Yes [Y]
[QG24Q1_other] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Other)	
[QG24Q11] Please elaborate further on the measures taken:	According to the 12-year education system, the child starts attending school from the age of 6. However, the Procedure for admission to, transfer from and removal of a learner from a general education institution of the Republic of Armenia regulates also the enrolment in school of those children who, for different reasons, have not attended school on time. In compliance with the referred procedure, children above 16 not having attended school may master the general education programmes through self-education and as an external student obtain a basic education certificate (or academic certificate of

	secondary education). Pursuant to the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On making amendments to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On education'" (HO-20-N) of 8 April 2015, 12-year secondary education in the Republic of Armenia may be realised before the learner attains the age of 19, if this right has not been exercised earlier. The term "education of adults" has been used in the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education". The Law provides for the implementation of education of adults along with other educational programmes within primary vocational and secondary vocational education institutions. In this context, short-term (1-6 months) educational programmes are also implemented at primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education institutions for professions in demand in the labour market. Persons having completed those courses are granted a completion document, namely a certificate. As of 2019, 26 out of 97 institutions implementing preliminary (craftsmanship) and vocational education programs have been completed 99 short-term vocational training programs have been completed. Nine hundred eighty-three people participated in the program. In 2020, in 46 preliminary (craftsmanship) and vocational is planned to implement 123 short-term vocational training programs. The number of participants will be 1858, according to the plan. The following essential provision has been enshrined in the Procedure for admission to state and non-state higher vocational education institutions of the Republic of Armenia of the Government of the Republic of Armenia N 597-N of 26 April 2012: "Persons with secondary education, primary vocational education or secondary vocational education may be admitted to higher education institutions without any age limit." Since it is impossible to ensure the harmonious development of a person and his or her competitiveness in the labour market only through a formal education system in the current rapidly changing social-economic conditions, the regulation of the field of supplementary and continuing education, the assessment and recognition of knowledge, abilities and skills gained through non-formal and informal training have become important in Armenia, as well as in many European countries. As a comparatively newly established direction in the system of education in the Republic of Armenia, the field of supplementary and continuing education is in need of reforms, particularly improvement of the legal framework. As a result of the study of the current situation in this field and analysis thereof, the Strategy and Action Plan for Supplementary and Continuing Education in the Republic of Armenia have been approved by Order of the Minister of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia N 1163-A/Q of 20 December 2012. And the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On making supplements and amendments to the Law of the Republic of Armenia 'On education'" (HO-83-N) was adopted on 21 June 2014, which served as a ground for the approval of the Procedure for organising and implementing supplementary education programmes and the Procedure for assessment and recognition of the results of non-formal and informal instruction, prescribed by points 1 and 2 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia N 1062-N of 10
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	September 2015. In implementing the approved procedures, each person, irrespective of national, religious or racial affiliation or educational degree, will have the right to make his or her knowledge, abilities and skills gained by any means (non-formal, informal), recognised by the State, as well as benefit from the supplementary education programmes offered by natural and legal persons guaranteed by the State in order to be competitive in the labour market and be employed. For the purpose of disseminating the ideology of supplementary and continuing education and raising awareness about the current policy, an information guide and methodical manual entitled "Supplementary and Continuing Education" have been drafted, a team of trainers has been formed, which conducts courses based on a training manual with representatives of primary vocational and secondary vocational education institutions of Yerevan and of all provinces of the Republic of Armenia implementing supplementary education programmes, territorial employment agencies and employers. In the context of ensuring interrelation between the labour market and the educational system, the "Concept Paper on Development of Professional Orientation in the Republic of Armenia" approved by point 1 of Protocol Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia N 40 of 4 October 2012 proposes to introduce such a model of professional orientation system, the essential basis of which will be the ensuring of opportunities for the effective selection, change of profession and continuing development of a career for persons in different age groups and in different social and working situations throughout their whole lives, taking into consideration the personal attributes of a person, as well as the changing situation of the labour market. The exclusion of any type of discrimination in regard to professional orientation is singled out in the main principles for the introduction of the system. In the presented model, the main levels providing services are the system of general education, primary vocational (handicraft), secondary vocational and higher professional education, as well as the territorial employment centres, the institutes for the selection of a profession, career guidance, re-specialisation and requalification that are out of the educational system. An objective has been set to enhance the existing Methodical Centre for Professional Orientation and reserve the ensuring of methodologies and training of specialists of the structures of the system to it. The "Career Management" modular programme has been drafted and is envisaged to be introduced at vocational education and training institutions as an optional subject. From 2013 till now, the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia, jointly with the "Methodical Centre for Professional Orientation" SNCO and with the support of the European Foundation for Education, has carried out activities for the introduction and exploitation of career centres at 22 vocational education and training institutions. Higher education institutions have also established career centres, the main goal whereof is to strengthen the bonds between the labour market and the higher education institution and support students in their internships and alumni in finding jobs. The "Methodical Centre for Professional Orientation" SNCO also greatly supports to learners of the 9th
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	year of basic school and those of high schools with respect to professional orientation. The supporting manual "Disciplinary Work in School: Problems of Professional Orientation" and the relevant modules of the manual (for each age group) have been published for supervising teachers. Every year, the Centre conducts training courses for deputy directors for specialised assistance and supervising teachers in a certain number of general education schools of the marzes of the Republic of Armenia and in Yerevan. Learners are informed about professional orientation issues during the classes of the supervising teachers. One of the 14 annual programmes carried out by the State Employment Agency through the State Budget of the Republic of Armenia within the scope of state employment support programmes is the programme "Organising of Professional (Vocational) Instruction for Unemployed Persons and Job Seekers Facing the Risk of Dismissal", the goal of which is to ensure stable employment by preparing specialists in accordance with the demands of the labour market and by raising the level of their competitiveness in the labour market. Beneficiaries of the programme are unemployed persons and job seekers facing the risk of dismissal. Professional (vocational) preparation (primary vocational preparation and handicraft instruction) is organised within the framework of the programme for up to 6 months, and re-specialisation and raising of qualification – for up to 3 months. A stipend is paid to the job seeker engaged in the professional (vocational) training courses every month during the whole period of the training. At least 11% of those included in the programme are expected to be persons with disabilities.
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[QG25Q1_1] Please indicate the measures taken by your country to ensure equivalence in all educational institutions with regard to: (Establishment of minimum norms and standards in education)	Yes [Y]
[QG25Q1_2] Please indicate the measures taken by your country to ensure	Yes [Y]

equivalence in all educational institutions with regard to: (Establishment of conditions relating to the quality of the education provided (e.g. infrastructure, learner/teacher ratios, teaching and learning materials, use of ICT))	
[QG25Q1_3] Please indicate the measures taken by your country to ensure equivalence in all educational institutions with regard to: (Adoption of legal or regulatory provisions to ensure that children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools).)	Yes [Y]
[QG25Q11] Please elaborate further on the measures taken:	Pursuant to the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On education", "State educational standards shall be established and promulgated in the Republic of Armenia, which shall be deemed as the basis for assessment of education level and qualification of graduates, irrespective of the form of education they have received as well as legal and organisational form of educational institutions". Uniform state educational standards shall be established for educational programmes implemented at different levels of education in the Republic of Armenia. State standards of secondary education, higher and postgraduate professional education shall be established by the Government of the Republic of Armenia. State standards of secondary vocational education shall be established by the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia. Ensuring compliance with the requirements of state educational standards is compulsory for both state, as well as private/non-state education institutions. In 2019, the Ministry of Education, Science, Culture, and Sports of the Republic of Armenia started reviewing the State Standards of School Education and Subject Standards. Last time STEM (Science, Engineering, ICT/Computer Science, Mathematics, and Geography) and Humanities standards were revised 15 years ago. State standards for STEM subjects are being reviewed under the EU-funded Innovation Program in Armenia. Humanities standards are being reviewed under the World Bank's Education Improvement Program's "Improving the Quality of Public Education through Reviewing the National Curriculum and Standards" Sub-Program. Due to the reforms under the Bologna and Turin Processes, educational standards were revised in the field of professional education as well. The new standards are targeted at improvement of the quality of professional education, capacity building for personnel training in compliance with the demands of the labour market and European standards.

	The State Inspectorate for Education was established in 2005 for the purpose of evaluating the efficiency of implementation of educational programmes, exercising state supervision over the quality assurance of education within educational institutions and other organisations implementing general education programmes and primary vocational (handicraft) education programmes. Licensing is deemed as a process of official authorisation of educational activities of an educational institution. The education programmes provided for by law may be implemented only in case of availability of a licence — a document certifying the right to official authorisation. The licence is issued to an educational institution in case of meeting the following requirements: availability of main pedagogical and/or academic and teaching staff, laboratory base and teaching space, teaching and methodical support, library and information system, educational internship base. With a view of rendering an opinion on licensing of education programmes of educational institutions, Licensing Agency was established and currently operates within the staff of the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia upon point 1 of the Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 676-N of 12 May 2011. The Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia has undertaken the improvement of licensing process and several legal acts have been adopted having their aim to exercise supervision over the compliance with the conditions and requirements of licences for the activities carried out under higher professional education programmes and to impose sanctions in case of failure of complying therewith. In its turn, it has fostered the responsibility for educational activities carried out in the field of higher education by considerably raising the effectiveness of handling the problems existing in the higher education system. In accordance with the Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 18 N of 10 January 2013 the applications on licensing and reports may be submitted by licensed persons to the licensing body also through an electronic system, which facilitates the implementation of licensing process by interested organisations by considerably simplifying the licensing process and making the field more transparent. The Law of the Republic of Armenia (HO-84-N) "On making amendments to the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On licensing"" was adopted on 19 June 2013, which was conditioned by the current reforms in the field of education and is aimed at implementing the principles of Bologna process. The educational institutions carrying out professional medical education programmes pursue their educational activities upon laws and legal acts regulating the field, as well as implement education programmes by ensuring the instruction of learners in compliance with the requirements of these programmes. However, by 2015, the authorisation of educational activities (licence) was issued by another agency (Ministry of Health of the Republic of Armenia). Hereinafter, the licensing process is being implemented out by the Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sport of the Republic of Armenia also in respect of medical professions. The aim of the amendments to the law is to have single state policy, single standards of state policy in the
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	field of education, as well as to ensure equal framework for licensing conditions and requirements for educational institutions, which will foster responsibility for educational activities carried out in the field of education by considerably raising the effectiveness of handling problems existing in the professional education system. "National Centre for Professional Education Quality Assurance Foundation" (ANCA) was established upon point 1 of the Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1486-N of 27 November 2008. Starting from 2015, higher professional education institutions of the Republic of Armenia started receiving accreditation by ANCA. ANCA holds full and associate membership in International Network for Quality Assurance Agencies Of Higher Education (INQAAHE) and European Association for Quality Assurance Of Higher Education (ENQA) respectively. It has its aim of fostering international recognition of the quality of higher education of the Republic of Armenia and ensuring the competitiveness thereof. The graduation documents issued by higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia accredited by ANCA are recognised by the European Higher Education Area (EHEA). ANCA is in charge of external quality assessment and quality assurance of higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia. EU TEMPUS and TWINNING programmes have key role in improvement of quality of education within the framework whereof all actors of higher education system of the Republic of Armenia manage to improve, upon active exchange of experience and joint activities with EHEA countries, the infrastructures of the higher education system of the Republic of Armenia and receive an opportunity of undergoing training in order to work under EHEA standards. In 2011-2012, internal quality assurance centres have been established within higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia. In 2015 the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia, with the support of Council of Europe (CoE), within the framework of "Strengthening Integrity and Combating Corruption in Higher Education in Armenia" project and jointly with the expert group and higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, elaborated model ethics codes (rules of conduct) and guidelines for the development thereof, which will enable the higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia to develop own rules of conduct with a view of strengthening integrity within higher education. When describing certain values in the model form, 'non-discrimination' and 'discrimination' expressions were stressed, as was the case with descriptions of values of 'fairness', 'impartiality, justice and social justice', 'respect for others'. These values (principles) and the remainder of those included in the model form are mainly based on the elaboration of Pan-European Platform on Ethics, Transparency and Integrity in Education (ETINED) of the Council of Europe and on two documents constituting a part of initiative on this platform — Ethical Principles (for Education) and Ethical Behaviour of All Actors in Education (Smith and Hamilton, 2015). The aforementioned principles and documents have been considered during elaboration of the new Draft Law of the Republic of Armenia "On higher education". In 2014, "Ethical
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	Norms for Teachers”was elaborated and introduced in all general education schools of the Republic of Armenia.
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Comptage des fichiers:	0
[QG26Q1_1] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Teachers' average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels))	Yes [Y]
[QG26Q1_2] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Initial training and continuous professional development is provided)	Yes [Y]
[QG26Q1_3] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Minimum standards and	Yes [Y]

qualifications are required for the teaching profession)	
[QG26Q1_4] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession)	
[QG26Q1_5] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Performance monitoring systems)	
[QG26Q1_6] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education)	
[QG26Q1_other] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Other)	
[QG26Q11] Please briefly elaborate further on the measures taken:	The Government of the Republic of Armenia undertakes continuous measures aimed at improving the professionalism of pedagogues, public standing thereof and raising the attractiveness of the profession of a teacher. According to the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On education" "The remuneration rate for the work carried out by pedagogical (academic and teaching) staff at state education institutions may not be lower than the average salary of employees of

	budgetary institutions". This requirement of the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On education" is ensured in the field of professional education. Professional education institutions provide the academic and teaching staff with increments at the expense of funds received from their paid instruction systems. A policy on increasing the salaries of pedagogues is implemented for the purpose of increasing the interest in the profession of pedagogue and improving the quality of education in the field of general education. In September 2019, teachers' salaries were increased by 10%, and since January 2020, the concept of a teacher's minimum salary, regardless of the number of students, was fixed. Each year, "Best Teacher of the Year", "Best Principal of the Year" and "Best Educator of the Year" contests are organised; the best candidates are granted with awards by the Prime Minister of the Republic of Armenia and the Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sport of the Republic of Armenia. Armenia participates in EU eTwinning project wherein teachers from Armenian schools, specialised in different subjects, act very actively and show good results. Online events, forums and contests are organised with cooperating schools in abroad. In accordance with Article 50 of the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On education" adopted in 1999, The Government of the Republic of Armenia has defined additional remuneration for teachers of general education schools in borderline, highland and mountainous settlements. The system of granting qualification grades through competence evaluation of teachers of general education institutions is introduced upon point 3 of the Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1745-N of 10 November 2011, which enables teachers to receive increments for the creative work performed thereby and active professional activities thereof. Continuous works are implemented with regard to raising the organisational and financial autonomy, accountability, effectiveness of management of higher education institutions. Within the framework of this process state higher education institutions have changed their legal and organisational form by becoming a foundation from the state of SNCO. This change implies also development of entrepreneurial activities in higher education institutions, in the result whereof the higher education institution will become more independent and will have an opportunity to maintain close contacts with the private sector, to improve the quality of education by combining education, research and practical work. In line with the introduction of the 12-year system of education, training of teachers implemented in the regions of the Republic of Armenia and in the city of Yerevan at the expense of State Budget of the Republic of Armenia. The training programme included topics on computer literacy, new education programmes, legislation, inclusive education, system of assessment and new teaching methods (80 hours). In recent years the pedagogical staff makes use of the social package designed for state servants of the Republic of Armenia. The Procedure "For training of lecturers of educational institutions implementing primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education programmes and that of masters of practical instruction" has been approved upon the Order of the Minister of Education and Science of the Republic of
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	Armenia No 1058-N of 29 October 2014. Pursuant to the existing procedure trainings for lectures and masters of practical instruction have been implemented, which were attended by teaching staff from all state education institutions of the system. For the purpose of supporting the education centres of Diaspora and contributing to the preservation of Armenian identity, the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia and the Ministry of Diaspora of the Republic of Armenia carried out intensive instruction of Armenian language, training courses for teachers of Armenian language and history, team leaders and dancing-masters, within the framework of "Diaspora" Summer School Programme. Thus, the choice of a profession is free and learners choose the profession of a pedagogue based on their preferences and abilities. Therefore, the participation in training courses for pedagogues does not presume any discrimination; trainings are designed for all practising pedagogues. At the same time, Teach for Armenia organization is playing an essential role in terms of staffing schools with teachers. As part of the program, the participants of the Leadership Development Program travel to remote villages, where they start teaching in schools with a shortage of teachers, thus contributing to the improvement of education quality. The teachers sent to these villages receive additional monetary compensation. Teachers working in rural schools, which are located more than 5 km away, also receive compensation.
[QG26Q2] Have there been instances of discrimination as regards the training for education personnel in your country?	No [N]
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[QG27_1] Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms:	Yes [Y]

(Curriculum includes human rights education)	
[QG27_2] Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms: (Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education)	Yes [Y]
[QG27_other] Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms: (Other)	
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[QG28Q1] Does your country have a regulatory framework relating to the establishment and functioning of private educational institutions?	Yes [Y]
[QG28Q11] Please provide a brief description:	Pursuant to the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On education", "State educational standards shall be established and promulgated in the Republic of Armenia, which shall be deemed as the basis for assessment of education level and qualification of graduates, irrespective of the form of education they have received as well as legal and organisational form of educational institutions". Uniform state educational standards shall be established for educational programmes implemented at different levels of education in the Republic of Armenia. State standards of secondary education, higher and postgraduate professional education shall be established by the Government of the Republic of Armenia. State standards of secondary

	vocational education shall be established by the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia. Ensuring compliance with the requirements of state educational standards is compulsory for both state, as well as private/non-state education institutions.
[QG28Q2] Do legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation [1] explicitly apply to private educational institutions?	Yes [Y]
[QG28Q21] Please briefly describe what laws, regulations or policies guarantee that the development of private education does not generate discrimination and that private schools offer a relevant alternative in your country:	In the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On education" the principles of state policy on education of the Republic of Armenia enshrine the following provisions: • guaranteeing for citizens opportunities of receiving education in state and non-state education institutions; • ensuring legally equal status of state and accredited non-state education institutions and that of graduation documents issued thereby. Non-state education institutions are also available in the Republic of Armenia, wherein education services are also rendered on paid basis. The non-state education institutions may be established only as prescribed by law, whereas education programmes may be implemented therein only in case of availability of relevant licence. Non-state higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, accredited by the NCQA, acquire state-funded free of charge seats for instruction (as in case of state higher education institutions). In state and non-state schools the standard requirements, syllabus requirements, as well as those to graduates are deemed as uniform and the same for all. Non-state schools implement also foreign, optional, authorial general education programmes which are prescribed by law and may not contradict the requirements for state standard of general education. Non-state general education institutions acquire the right to issue a state-recognised graduation document upon receiving relevant licence. Secondary vocational and higher professional education institutions undergo accreditation process carried out as of the education institutions and professions thereof. Accreditation process provides an opportunity to create legally equal conditions for learners and graduates of state and non-state education institutions. A state final competence evaluation examination is organised for graduates of previous years having received education under secondary vocational and higher professional education programmes, as a result whereof a state-recognised diploma is issued. In case of violating the conditions and requirements of licensing, the licence of the educational institution for implementing educational programmes may be withdrawn. Procedure for admission to state and non-state higher education institutions (according to Bachelor's degree education programme), which was approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 597-N of 26 April 2012. Admission to state and accredited non-state institutions of handicraft and secondary vocational education shall be carried out according to the

	admission procedure approved by the Order of the Minister of Education and Science for the given academic year. "Ayb" school has a remarkable place in the educational system of Armenia. Teaching at Ayb School is provided by the Araratian Baccalaureate (AB) Armenian Educational Program, developed by the Ayb Educational Foundation. The AB is a world-class competitive, and demanding curriculum designed for modern public and private educational institutions. The AB is explicitly designed for Armenian schools, and the teaching is in Armenian. The AB program combines several core and elective subjects, including Mathematics, Science, History, Social Studies, Languages, and Art. A Fablab has been opened next to the school, a workshop-laboratory created by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology, where students apply the theory in practice. The UWC College, which has an international reputation, operates in Dilijan, Armenia. UWC has 18 schools and colleges on four continents, most of which focus on the 16-19 age group. As part of the program, students from many countries have the opportunity to study for two years at a college, becoming the bearers of cultural exchange, unique experience, and quality education. These schools, being the centers of excellence and differing in their status from public schools, are legally equal to public schools (as are other non-public schools).
[QG28Q3] Does your country have an education policy framework for minimum educational standards as regards the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children?	Yes [Y]
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[QG29Q1_1] Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities: (Constitutional laws and/or legislation	Yes [Y]

protect the right to education of national minorities)	
[QG29Q1_2] Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities: (Legislation or regulations guarantee the right of national minorities to study in their mother tongue)	Yes [Y]
[QG29Q1_3] Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities: (Curriculum is adapted to national minority needs)	Yes [Y]
[QG29Q1_4] Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities: (Teachers are trained to adapt to national minority needs)	
[QG29Q1_other] Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities: (Other)	
[QG29Q11] Please provide a brief description of the provisions:	The Constitution of the Republic of Armenia is deemed as the main core element for implementation of state policy on the protection of the rights of persons holding affiliation to national minorities. In particular, pursuant to Article 38 of the amendments made to the Constitution of the Republic of Armenia adopted on 6 December 2015: "Everyone shall have the right to education. The programmes on and duration of compulsory education shall be prescribed by law. Secondary education in state education institutions shall be free of charge. Everyone shall, in the cases and under the procedure provided for by law, have the right to receive free education on a competitive basis in state higher and other vocational education institutions". While Article 56 states: "Everyone shall have the right to preserve his or her national and ethnic identity. Persons holding affiliation to national minorities shall have the right to preserve and develop their traditions, religion, language and culture".

[QG29Q2] As regards the educational standards in educational institutions run by minorities, please describe the existing legal and policy framework:

Pursuant to the Laws of the Republic of Armenia "On general education" and "On language", the general education and upbringing in the communities of national minorities of the Republic of Armenia may be organised in their native language, within state programme and under state sponsorship, by compulsory instruction of the Armenian language". At the same time, pursuant to Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1392-N of 25 July 2002, in individual cases (at schools in mountainous, highland, borderline rural settlements, in urban and rural schools possessing classes in the languages of national minorities and in other cases) a class with less learners may be opened upon the authorisation of the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia. This Decision provides an opportunity of opening classes comprised of only Yezidi children in Yezidi-populated communities. Pursuant to the Procedure "For enrolment of a learner in an educational institution implementing basic general education programmes of the Republic of Armenia, for the transfer and dismissal of a learner from the institution, as well as for the organisation of education of children having been enrolled in general education later than the prescribed period", approved by the Order of the Minister of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia No 400-N of 5 May 2016, the learner holding affiliation to a national minority is enrolled in school (class) providing an instruction of the national (native) language of the learner or in school (class) providing a course on that language, whereas in case of non-availability thereof — the parent of the learner selects the language of instruction. Each year school textbooks are published and republished for the schools of national minorities, and regular trainings are conducted for teachers of the schools of national minorities. Each year the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia approves model curriculum of general education schools (classes) of national minorities where class hours are allocated for studying native language, literature, culture and history of national minorities for the 1st-12th grades (41 class hours per week). For the instruction of the subject entitled "Native Language and Literature" 4 class hours a week are allocated for 1st-5th grades each, and 3 class hours a week — for the 6th-12th grades each. Furthermore, in the settlements with mixed population where the number of national minorities is small, an opportunity of facultative instruction of language is envisaged. The instruction of Yezidi and Kurdish is carried out in elementary grades of the schools of rural areas resided by Yezidis and Kurds in case of availability of relevant specialist, irrespective of the number of children. On the basis of preliminary applications submitted by the communities of national minorities residing in Armenia funds are allocated from the State Budget for the publication of textbooks. Classes with the instruction of the Russian language operate in 42 general education schools for the population of Russian and Slavic national origin, where the instruction of general education subjects is carried out in Russian, except for the subjects entitled "Armenian language and literature" and the "History of Armenia". Meanwhile, around 60 general education schools are available in the Republic, which provide advanced instruction of

	the Russian language: the Russian language is taught starting from the 1st grade. Special textbooks and methodological manuals have been published for these schools. Textbooks recommended by the Ministry of Education and Science of the Russian Federation, as well as syllabuses recommended and approved by the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia are used at schools (classes) with the instruction of Russian language. The applicants holding affiliation to national minorities of the Republic of Armenia are admitted to higher education institutions both on general grounds and based on the applications submitted by the heads of national minorities. Subsequently, upon the motion of the Coordinating Council for National and Cultural Organisations of National Minorities of the Republic of Armenia, the higher education institutions apply full or partial discount of the tuition fee for students. It should be mentioned with regret that proper interest and motivation for higher professional education yet have not been developed among national minorities. With a view of raising awareness among them, particularly at the initiative of the Yezidi community, numerous events are organised aimed at increasing the focus by the Yezidis on the professional education, which are actively attended by the representatives of the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia. The applicants holding affiliation to national minorities, who are admitted to state higher education institutions, avail of the privileges defined by the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On education", including participation in the rotation process arranged at higher education institutions, as well as enjoy the right to discount of the tuition fee in the prescribed manner, are provided with state educational allowances, participate, as of their preferences and in the prescribed manner, in inter-higher education institution and intra- higher education institution exchange process, participate in the admission to Master's Degree studies, etc.
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[QG210Q1] Please briefly describe the existing legal and policy framework that protects the right to quality education for refugees and migrants in your country:	The admission of foreign nationals (including representatives of the Armenian Diaspora) to vocational education institutions of the Republic of Armenia is regulated by international treaties of the Republic of Armenia on co-operation in the sectors of education and science concluded between the Republic of Armenia and other states, as well as in accordance with the

	Procedure for admission of foreign nationals, as well as members of families of diplomats working in the diplomatic service bodies of the Republic of Armenia, operating in a foreign state, to higher education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 700-N of 28 April 2011, the Procedure for admission to primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, approved by point 1 of Decision of the Government of the Republic of Armenia No 1295-N of 25 August 2011. The purpose of the existence of separate procedures for admission is to: make education at educational institutions of the Republic of Armenia accessible for foreign nationals; contribute to upbringing with the spirit of respect towards nations and mutual understanding, help spark interest among the youth in Armenian cultural heritage and contribute to the development of Armenian studies. Foreign nationals having received secondary education in the Republic of Armenia and residing in Armenia (including refugees, persons having received temporary shelter, etc.) may also be admitted to primary vocational (handicraft) and secondary vocational, higher education and research institutions on a general basis. The examination questions are translated during entrance examinations for those lacking knowledge of the Armenian language. In the rest of the cases, all the prescribed conditions of the competition apply to them equally, and in case of earning high points — they have the right to benefit from free of charge (stipend) seats. Applicants having preferred to be admitted through the procedure for admission for foreign nationals may be admitted to the fee paid education system (first year) of primary vocational (handicraft), secondary vocational and higher education institutions, where they are fluent in the Armenian language and have minimum knowledge of the examination subjects. Foreign applicants having been admitted to state higher professional education institutions of the Republic of Armenia, with no knowledge of the Armenian language, are admitted to the preparatory faculty (departments) of higher education institutions for a one-year period, where they learn Armenian and study admission examination subjects. According to the mentioned procedure, foreigners of Armenian origin or representatives of Armenian Diaspora may be allocated with 70 free of charge (stipend) seats where they have applied for the professions of Armenian studies, Pedagogy and Art. Foreign citizens are provided with dormitories, if they wish. 2012, tuition fees of Syrian-Armenian students have been fully or partially — 70-75 % — refunded at the expense of resources of the Government of the Republic of Armenia, The Armenian General Benevolent Union and the Calouste Gulbenkian Foundation.
[QG210Q2_1] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Inclusion in mainstream education)	Yes [Y]

[QG210Q2_2] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Provision of language courses)	Yes [Y]
[QG210Q2_3] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Specific training for educational staff)	
[QG210Q2_4] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Initiatives addressing discrimination and promoting cultural diversity and mutual acceptance)	Yes [Y]
[QG210Q2_5] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Alternative administrative procedure (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.))	
[QG210Q2_6] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Accelerated learning programmes)	Yes [Y]
[QG210Q2_7] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes)	
[QG210Q2_8] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Financial support)	

[QG210Q2_other] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Other)	
[QG210Q3] Please briefly elaborate further on the measures taken:	Education in the Republic of Armenia is provided in accordance with the requirements of the Law of the Republic of Armenia "On language": "The official language of the Republic of Armenia is Armenian which shall serve all spheres of life of the Republic. The language of teaching and upbringing in education and learning systems within the territory of the Republic of Armenia is literary Armenian. Students are admitted to general education schools based on the Regulation "On enrolling children of school age into general education, organizing teaching and learning for the children enrolled in general education later than planned, and moving the students from one education institution to another and dismissing them", as approved by Order No 06-N of the RA Minister of Education, Science, Culture and Sport, dated as of May 15, 2020. Pursuant to paragraph 6 of this Regulation, "foreign nationals, persons with no citizenship (legal representative thereof) (as well as in cases when one of the parents is a citizen of the Republic of Armenia, and the other one – any of the one mentioned herein) shall choose the language of instruction for their child independently. In the remaining cases, when the learner's parents are citizens of the Republic of Armenia, the language of instruction is Armenian". Students are admitted to education institutions by way of order of the school principal, based on the application from the parent of the child of school-going age or the legal representative thereof and on the contract concluded between the institution and the parent, in accordance with the procedure established by the RA Law on General Education and the Charter of the education institution. At the 3rd level of general education – high school –students may pursue further studies only upon availability of the basic school graduation certificate. General education starts from age six, which may be full by the end of the given calendar year. In case of availability of documents on taken study and compliance of the length of education levels, the grade of the student, who has discontinued his/her study abroad and returned to the Republic of Armenia, shall be determined based on the documents furnished. The grade of the student, who has returned from abroad without relevant documents, shall be determined in accordance with the provisions specified in the Regulation. The school principal shall admit the learner to corresponding grade, approve the subject-specific individual study plans furnished by the teachers' subject-specific methodological units as per the curriculum, and the timetable of extra courses, whereby the learner's study will be organized to catch up. Courses of Armenian language were organized for those who received asylum, refugee status in the Republic of Armenia, as well as for long-term migrants. In 2018 the Ministry organized the courses based on a memorandum of understanding with the AGBU Armenian Virtual university. The university committed to fund and organize free-of-charge

	training courses for 60 individuals. In 2018 Armenian language courses were taken by 25 refugees, and in 2019 0 by 10 refugees. A new state program was initiated in the process of planning the 2019 State budget to organize Armenian language course for children of migrant families. Implementation will start from 2020-2021 school year. Pursuant to Article 14 of the Law on "Making Amendments and Addenda to the Law on the Structure and Activities of the Government" of 16 May, 2019, the Ministries of Culture, Sports and Youth Affairs and Education and Science were merged into one- the Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sports. The Ministry of Diaspora has been reorganized into the Office of the Chief Commissioner for Diaspora Affairs, from now on operating in the Office of the Prime Minister of the Republic of Armenia.
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[QG31Q1_1] Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Challenges related to equitable access and inclusion in education (such as poverty and socio-economic factors, cultural and traditional attitudes, remoteness, migration and displacement, etc.))	Yes [Y]
[QG31Q1_1comment] Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing	• Social inequality at all levels entails challenges related to enrollment and drop-out, • Due to social problems, a number of children from disadvantaged families (equally relevant for boys and girls) drop out of school in some stage of their studies, which is an obstruction for them to pursue vocational education,

the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Comment)	thereby increasing the risk of falling into poverty in the future. It is worth noting that boys mostly drop out because of work. This is more common in rural settlement, • Due to early marriage, Yezidi girls do not get higher education after finishing school. Most often girls of this category marry off at 15 or 16 and even don't finish school, • The enrolment indicator of learners in the third degree of general education is low, • The enrolment of the poor, especially those in extreme poverty, higher professional education system is low, • In terms of chances to get higher education, girls residing in rural areas are more vulnerable, which entails unequal treatment in the future, • Higher education is not sufficiently accessible and available for persons in need of special conditions for education, • Children residing in rural communities do not have an opportunity to visit cultural centres (museum, theatre, cinema, concert hall, etc.) since such visits assume transportation costs which may become an additional financial burden for their families, • Students and teachers have gender stereotypes, so it is necessary to enlarge the teaching of gender issues at all levels of education, • The rights of the main participants of the education process i.e. students and teachers, are not sufficiently respected, and in this respect they are vulnerable, • The human rights component is not sufficiently taught, it needs to be expanded starting from pre-school to include information about other nations and their cultures, • There is insufficient awareness among parents about the role and importance of education.
[QG31Q1_2] Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Challenges related to the quality of education (such as shortages of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff, non-supportive or inadequate teaching and learning as well as school environment, etc.))	Yes [Y]
[QG31Q1_2comment] Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and	• Transition from Western Armenian to Eastern Armenian creates difficulties for immigrant schoolchildren of Armenian national origin, • Activities aimed at extracurricular/out-of-school upbringing of children are not effectively organised. The social condition of families impedes the effective organisation of leisure of children, particularly attendance thereby in interest groups in music, art, sports which are mainly arranged on paid basis, • General education schools have limited capacities for

practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Comment)	providing education to children in need of special conditions for education; the teaching staff needs trainings on inclusive education, • Educational and material resources and conditions of buildings of many educational institutions fail to comply with contemporary requirements. Building conditions of educational institutions are not accessible for persons with disabilities so they must be adapted, • The network of hostel buildings is required to be improved in accordance with the format of urban-type European universities.
[QG31Q1_3] Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Challenges relating to the system and governance (such as budgetary constraints, lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data, absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment, lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels, etc.))	Yes [Y]
[QG31Q1_3comment] Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Comment)	• The pre-school institutions are not functioning in all communities, as a result the availability of pre-school educational services and the involvement of children in this field is low, • The system of keeping on records the children having been dropped out of schools and that of involvement thereof in education, is incomplete, • The data on the involvement of children in need of special conditions for education are not complete, • A non-classified official statistics on the inclusion of national minorities in different educational levels is not collected, • An official statistics on the cases of violence against children in general education schools and on reasons giving rise thereto, is not collected. For the purpose of giving an assessment to the mentioned phenomenon inquiries and surveys are sometimes carried out upon the initiative of separate organisations.
[QG31Q1_other] Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing	

the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Other)	
[QG31Q1_othercomment] Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Other comment)	
[QG31Q2] Please provide a brief assessment of the effectiveness of the methods introduced to remove the obstacles encountered:	• The network of pre-school services is not sufficiently developed, which would have increased the accessibility of pre-school education. • In Armenia, general education is available to everyone, for boys and girls, but the unequal involvement of students conditioned by gender and separate regions continues to be a challenge. In particular, in the 2018/2019 academic year, the gender equality index in the general secondary school was 1,04. • The difference between the poor and the non-poor in the higher education is quite noticeable, which is a serious challenge in terms of overcoming poverty. In this regard, the issue of affordability of higher education continues to be problematic, which is due to the fact that after graduating from high school, the students of corresponding age from poor households are left out of the education system. • Although Armenia has adopted a policy of inclusive general education, problems in adapting the physical environment, educational materials and teachers' abilities to the needs of students with special educational needs still exist. • Distance learning at different levels of education is widely used in Armenia, but there is a need to improve the legislative framework and introduce new procedures in this area. • Inter-sectoral cooperation is weak, which hinders the rapid and effective decision-making.
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[r425q8_1] Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages)	Yes [Y]
[r425q8_2] Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education)	Yes [Y]
[r425q8_3] Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the	Yes [Y]

principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Increased public awareness through advocacy material on the Convention/ Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education)	
[r425q8_4] Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments)	
[r425q8_other] Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Other)	
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